"Iris"

A

Short Film Animation

A Capstone Project

Presented to the Faculty of the

College of Information Technology Education

PHINMA University of Iloilo

In Partial Fulfillment

of the Requirements for the degree

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

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Approval Sheet

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ABSTRACT

'Iris' is an animation fantasy drama film based on the life of a single father whose life is filled with bereavement and regret. Waking up each morning to perform his usual things with nothingness, he is accompanied by a magical guardian named Iris. Invisible to his sight, Iris tries her best to instigate the Father to live a good life. Little by little as she spends time watching the Father, she finds out the reason for his unhappy life leading her to find out about her origin as well. This animation will end with a moral on forgiveness and acceptance setting the stage for a new beginning in the life of the main character.

Through symbolic visuals and an expansion of vocal canons to visualize grief, isolation, and loss of loved ones, the animated short 'Iris' was a piece of artistic adversity. This short animated film is a health awareness raiser on the effect that unresolved bereavement has on relationships and the healing that can come about when using the visualization capabilities of animation to communicate complex emotions. By nurturing empathy and understanding, without offering medical solutions, Iris illustrates how animation can be a positive force in social awareness.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Title page ----------i

Approval Sheet----------ii

Acknowledgement----------iii

Abstract----------iv

Table of Contents----------v

List of Tables----------vii

CHAPTER I

Introduction----------1

Background of the Study----------1

Statement of the Problem----------2

Objectives of the Study----------3

Significance of the Study----------4

Scope and Limitation----------5

CHAPTER II

Literature Review----------8

Overview----------8

Animation----------9

Bereavement and Mental Health Issue----------10

Embracing Differences and Navigating Acceptance within Family Dynamics----------12

Rampant Youth Suicide----------13

Theories of Grief----------14

CHAPTER III

Methodology----------18

Research Description----------18

Research Methodology----------19

Data Analysis----------19

Research Design----------20

Collection Methods----------30

Selection Process of Digital Tool----------33

Project Management----------35

Tangible and Intangible Benefits----------39

Return of Investment(ROI)----------40

CHAPTER IV

Animation Content----------44

Synopsis----------44

Overview----------45

Scriptwriting----------47

Pre-Production Phase----------62

Design and Genre of the Animation----------62

Impression and Illustration of Character Design----------65

Turnaround Shots of the Characters----------68

Description of the Characters----------70

Relationships of the Characters----------67

Principles of Animation----------73

Production Phase----------76

Post-Production Phase----------84

CHAPTER V

Conclusion and Recommendation----------87

Conclusion----------87

Ethical Consideration----------87

Summary----------88

Curriculum Vitae----------90

Grammarian Certificate----------

References----------94

LIST OF TABLES

Gender Distribution of Respondents----------22

Course Distribution of Respondents----------23

Year Level Distribution of Respondents----------24

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COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY EDUCATION

CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION

BACKGROUND OF THE STUDY

Modern animation has grown far beyond its roots in entertainment today, it serves as a powerful medium for exploring human experiences and social issues. With advances in technology and evolving artistic techniques, animation has become capable of representing abstract concepts emotions, psychological states, and inner struggles in ways that resonate deeply with audiences.

The animated short film 'Iris' exemplifies this transformation. By blending symbolic imagery, expressive character design, and immersive soundscapes, Iris creates a viewing experience that is not only visually compelling but emotionally profound. It bridges the gap between art and advocacy, inviting audiences into conversations about mental health, grief, and resilience. In doing so, the film demonstrates how animation can function as more than storytelling that it can be a catalyst for empathy and awareness.

Mental health has emerged as one of the most pressing concerns in contemporary society, affecting individuals across age groups and cultural backgrounds. Issues such as grief, depression, and loneliness are often invisible yet deeply impactful. Digital Animation had its ability to visualize the intangible, offers a unique way to express and investigate these experiences. Iris explores the psychological journey of its characters, portraying the weight of unresolved loss and the search for hope.

Through the parallel narratives of the 'Man' and 'Iris', the film highlights how emotional trauma can shape relationships and hinder recovery, while also suggesting pathways toward resilience. By engaging viewers in this exploration, 'Iris' encourages reflection on personal emotional realities and underscores the importance of mental health awareness. In the end, the project positions animation as a medium not only for artistic expression but also for social change capable of fostering empathy, sparking dialogue, and cultivating a deeper understanding of the human condition.

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

In the today's generation, mental health had become increasingly significant as individuals faced challenges such as accepting loss, coping with unexpected deaths, and managing depression. This animated short film had explored these themes by delving into the emotional journey of loneliness, grief, and bereavement, while illustrating how hope and connections could provide solace. Through this narrative, the capstone project had aimed to address how unresolved loss shaped a person's state of mind and its effects on those around them, including unfulfilled connections such as that of Iris and the unnamed 'Man'.

This problem statement had included the following key points:

1. How could an animated short film have effectively depicted the psychological effects of grief and bereavement to raise awareness about mental health issues?

2. What visual and narrative techniques could have been used to convey the complexity of emotional struggles, such as loneliness and depression, in an animated format?

3. How had the character Iris symbolized hope and connection, and how could this symbolism have been effectively communicated through animation?

4. What role had the relationship between the Man and Iris played in illustrating the effects of loss and potential healing?

5. What impact could a short animated film like Iris have had on increasing public understanding and acceptance of mental health issues?

OBJECTIVES

The short animated film Iris had used visual storytelling to highlight subjects such as mental health, sorrow, and emotional resilience. The short film had aimed to create an engaging narrative for audiences by exploring the psychological consequences of loss and the journey toward hope. These aims had been intended to help the project effectively communicate its message while providing a meaningful and thought-provoking viewing experience.

1. To have created a narrative that highlighted the importance of finding light and connection during emotional struggles.

2. To have emphasized the significance of mental health awareness through a relatable and artistic medium.

3. To have utilized animation techniques that effectively conveyed abstract emotions and psychological states.

4. To have depicted the psychological effects of grief and bereavement through the film’s characters and storyline.

5. To have inspired audiences to reflect on their own experiences with loss and the importance of emotional healing.

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE STUDY

The short animated film 'Iris' is of tremendous significance as it aims to create a bridge between creative storytelling and mental health awareness through the tool of animation. Mental health is a pressing issue in today's society, and through the application of animation to the subject matter, it becomes possible to explore the complexities of emotion and experience in a realizable and consumable manner. Animation possesses the power to cut across social and cultural boundaries and, as such, is an effective medium with which to make sensitive subjects known, such as bereavement, depression, and suicide. By exploring such subjects through evocative imagery and narrative, 'Iris' not only makes the need for mental health so pressing, but it also opens up a discussion on the related stigma. The study reveals the power that animation holds over the attitudes of the viewer in regard to general social issues, encouraging empathy and knowledge and resulting in significant change. These are the important key points of the following:

1. Mental Health Awareness – The study had emphasized the importance of raising awareness about mental health issues such as grief, depression, and bereavement in an engaging and impactful way.

2. Advocacy Through Animation – It had showcased the role of animation as a versatile medium for storytelling that could effectively represent abstract emotional concepts.

3. Empathy and Understanding – By visualizing mental health struggles, animation had helped audiences connect with and better understand these experiences on a personal level.

4. Challenging Social Stigma – The project had encouraged open discussions about mental health, discrimination against members of the LGBT+ community, personal pressures, and bullying, breaking down the stigma that had often surrounded these topics.

5. Animation Narrative – It had uniquely combined visual storytelling, symbolism, and motion to convey emotions, themes, and complex ideas in ways that had transcended language and cultural barriers.

SCOPE AND DELIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY

The animated short film Iris had focused on exploring the psychological effects of grief, loneliness, and bereavement through the journey of its characters. The scope had been limited to the portrayal of mental health themes using visual storytelling techniques, including symbolism and color, within the short film format. It had not aimed to provide clinical solutions or cover all aspects of mental health but rather, it had sought to raise awareness and evoke empathy through a creative medium.

Scope:

1. Psychological Themes – The film had explored sadness, loneliness, and loss, concentrating on the emotional and psychological effects these experiences had on individuals.

2. Character Development – The characters' journeys had been central, with emphasis placed on their inner emotional challenges and progress, particularly as they had dealt with loss and loneliness.

3. Empathy Through Art – The project had aimed to introduced empathy in the audience, allowing them to comprehend and connect with the emotional pain that people who had lost loved ones might have been facing.

4. Visual Storytelling – The narrative had been delivered primarily through visual components such as color, symbolism, and sound design, which had expressed complex emotions and themes without relying heavily on words.

5. Non-Linear Storytelling – The narrative had incorporated fractured timelines and flashbacks to depict the nonlinear manner in which people had experienced loss.

Delimitation:

1. Limited Exploration of Other Mental Health Issues – While the film had discussed loss and loneliness, it had not gone into great detail about other mental health concerns such as depression or anxiety.

2. Abstract Art Style – The animation style of the capstone had been abstract and creative, which may have restricted the audience's connection with the visual representation of emotions.

3. Resource Constraints – Due to limitations in time, budget, and technical capacity, the animated short film had creatively utilized minimalist animation techniques and symbolic visuals to convey complex psychological themes of grief, loneliness, and bereavement.

4. Limited Character Perspectives – The film had focused on a small number of individuals rather than attempting to portray a diverse range of grieving and loneliness experiences or perspectives.

5. Short Film Format – The project had been confined to a short film, which had limited the depth and breadth of exploration into mental health subjects compared to what might have been possible in a longer-form motion picture.

CHAPTER II

REVIEW OF THE RELATED LITERATURE

This capstone project, had drawn inspiration from acclaimed Oscar winning and French animated films. The animation style had taken cues from the 2022 film Last Summer created by students at GOBELINS, Studio Ghibli's 2015 masterpiece The Tale of the Princess Kaguya by Isao Takahata, and the 2023 Oscar-winning animated short film The Boy, the Mole, the Fox, and the Horse written and directed by Peter Baynton and Charlie Mackesy. The story, meanwhile, had been influenced by the emotionally compelling 2021 short If Anything Happens I Love You written and directed by Will McCormack and Michael Govier in their directorial debut, and had incorporated themes from real-life scenarios within the modern generation.

The characters had been carefully crafted with inspiration from existing works. The titular character, Iris, had drawn elements from Tinker Bell in Peter Pan, Joy from Inside Out, and Ember Lumen from Elemental. The second protagonist, the 'Man', had been modeled after the unnamed male character in If Anything Happens I Love You and Brendan Fraser's portrayal in the 2022 film The Whale.

The background design had been rooted in real world influences, enhanced by the adoption of a stylized or freestyle animation approach, which had allowed for creative freedom in crafting unique characters and environments. Lastly, light and muted color palettes had been chosen to reflect and complement the distinct personalities of the characters, adding depth to their visual storytelling.

Animation

Animation had been the craft of bringing static images to life, making them dynamic, expressive, and engaging visual stories. It had combined artistic skill with technical knowledge to create movements that evoked emotional reactions, told stories, and fueled imagination. From conventional hand-drawn techniques to the advanced capabilities of computer-generated imagery (CGI), animation had evolved into a complex and powerful medium. Its applications had ranged from entertainment, education, and advertising to virtual reality, demonstrating its versatility and global reach. A key part of being successful in animation had been learning the fundamental principles that governed movement, timing, and character representation. These principles had served as the foundation on which animators could craft believable and engaging sequences that appealed to audiences.

According to Richard Williams, The Animator's Survival Kit (2009)[1] had been a seminal resource in animation, emphasizing the importance of mastering these core principles. Williams, a legendary animator, had offered insights on timing, weight, and performance that had been as relevant at the time of writing as when first introduced. His work had bridged the gap between traditional and modern techniques, ensuring that animators could adapt classical skills to digital and 3D animation. The book's emphasis on physics, anatomy, and emotional storytelling had continued to shape the industry, guiding animators to create works that had been both technically proficient and deeply engaging. By blending timeless lessons with practical applications, The Animator's

[1] Williams, R. (2009). The Animator's Survival Kit: Expanded edition. Faber & Faber.

Survival Kit had remained an indispensable guide for aspiring and professional animators alike.

Bereavement and Mental Health Issue

The link that had existed between bereavement and other mental health issues had been both real and profound, as the process of losing a loved one had often left deep-seated emotional challenges. These issues had tended to manifest in the form of depression, debilitating loneliness, and extreme grief. When such struggles had remained unmedicated and unresolved, they had profoundly affected the overall psychological composition of an individual, which in turn had influenced their well-being and social interactions with others.

Investigating these profound issues through creative outlets, such as the art of animation, had offered an effective and powerful way of raising awareness and creating greater insight into the challenges people had faced. Animated narratives, such as the short film Iris, had examined the complex depth of feeling inherently linked to the process of loss, effectively demonstrating how hope and connections with others could have provided essential solace in the face of despair and adversity. Through the visual and narrative depiction of these issues, the project had aimed to contribute meaningfully to the existing discourse surrounding mental health. It had emphasized the critical need for empathy, healing, and resilience that people had needed to develop when confronted with the extreme act of loss.

The study by Keyes et. al(2014)[2], who examined the impact of sudden death of a loved one on the development of common psychiatric disorders. They concluded that sudden death of a loved one is a common and highly traumatic event that increases risk of the development of psychiatric disorders, such as major depressive episodes, panic disorder, and post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), across the life course.

The intense and intricate psychological hurt of a bereaved father grieving the senseless and tragic suicide of his son, especially when this hurt had been further intensified by an inability to accept and comprehend his son's identity, had strongly resonated with the findings of the study conducted by Keyes et al. (2014) on the psychological effects of sudden loss. This landmark study had established that the sudden and abrupt loss of a loved one had been a traumatic event that had greatly increased the risk of developing a range of psychiatric disorders, such as major depression, panic disorder, and post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD).

In the story of the film, the father's intense grief had gone beyond being a straightforward and direct response to the loss experience; instead, it had been further complicated by his intense guilt over rejecting his son's actual identity. This inner struggle, coupled with the resultant sense of guilt, had created an emotional burden that had intricately complicated his existing hurt, thus demonstrating how a tragic and sudden loss could have caused long-term psychological pain that had persisted for a prolonged duration.

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[2] Keyes, K. M., Pratt, C., Galea, S., McLaughlin, K. A., Koenen, K. C., & Shear, M. K. (2014). The burden of loss: unexpected death of a loved one and psychiatric disorders across the life course in a national study. The American journal of psychiatry, 171(8), 864-871. https://doi.org/10.1176/appi.ajp.2014.1308113

Through its narrative, the short animation had illustrated how loss and guilt had been deeply intertwined, while also exploring the possibility of self-forgiveness that the father had struggled with. The study by Keyes et al. (2014) had shed light on and emphasized the broader implications linked with sudden loss, particularly when viewed through the lens of unresolved conflict and the suffocating weight of societal expectations. Emphasizing the deterioration of the father's mental health had been important, as it had not only described the effects constructed from experiences of loss and rejection but had also underscored a major critique concerning the need to provide unconditional love and acceptance to those one cherished. The story had ended by encouraging reflection on the suffocating weight of personal decisions, along with the pressing need to accept and love others before the possibility of doing so had been lost forever.

Embracing Differences and Navigating Acceptance within Family Dynamics

Being different within a family, particularly in the context of a conservative household, had been an emotionally challenging experience, especially for members of the LGBTQ+ community (Katz-Wise, Rosario, & Tsappis, 2016)[3]. Traditional family values had often emphasized conformity to societal norms, which had made it difficult for individuals to express their true identities without fear of judgment or rejection. In such environments, coming out or simply being authentic had frequently led to tension, misunderstanding, or estrangement.

[3] Katz-Wise, S. L., Rosario, M., & Tsappis, M. (2016). Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, and Transgender Youth and Family Acceptance. Pediatric clinics of North America, 63(6), 1011-1025. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pcl.2016.07.005

The pressure to align with expectations had created feelings of isolation, low self-worth, and internalized conflict. Exploring this dynamic through creative mediums, such as storytelling or animation, had provided an opportunity to foster empathy and understanding. It had shed light on the struggles faced by LGBTQ+ individuals in conservative families and had underscored the importance of acceptance, love, and inclusivity.

Rampant Youth Suicide

The loss of a teenager to suicide had been a devastating issue that had underscored the fragility of mental well-being in the modern generation. With pressures from academic demands, social media, and societal expectations, many young individuals had faced silent struggles that had often gone unnoticed. Such tragedies had left families and communities grappling with profound grief, guilt, and the stigma surrounding suicide, emphasizing the urgent need for open conversations and supportive environments. By exploring this issue through creative mediums, such as storytelling or animation, capstone projects had raised awareness, promoted understanding, and encouraged young people to seek help. These initiatives had aimed to foster a culture of empathy and prevention, addressing the importance of mental health and compassionate support systems.

Suicide had continued to be one of the leading causes of death globally, with approximately 700,000 individuals taking their lives each year (Alibudbud, 2023)[4]. Among teenagers,

[4] Alibudbud, R. (2023). Suicide among the youth and school-based suicide prevention: Exemplar and reflections from the Philippines. Asian Journal of Psychiatry. Volume 83. ISSN 1876-2018. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ajp.2023.103538

suicide had been the fourth leading cause of death, particularly within the age group of 15–29 years old, reflecting the vulnerability of young people facing mental health challenges (WHO, 2021). In low- and middle-income countries, the majority of suicides (77%) had occurred, indicating a need for improved mental health resources and support in these regions. In the Philippines, suicide rates had been reported at 2.5 per 100,000 population in 2019, a statistic that had reflected the rising concerns surrounding youth mental health in the country (Department of Health, 2019). Through this project, the animation Iris had sought to raise awareness about these critical issues, addressing the importance of mental health support and the long-term effects of unresolved grief following suicide.

Suicide had remained a critical public health issue, with alarming statistics highlighting its impact on young people worldwide. This capstone project had examined the emotional and psychological toll of teenage suicide, focusing on the effects of grief and loss, and had explored how animation could have been an effective medium for raising awareness and promoting understanding of mental health issues. By highlighting the struggles of those left behind, particularly in the context of familial and societal expectations, the project had aimed to provide a narrative that fostered empathy and had encouraged open discussions about mental health, grief, and healing.

Theories of Grief

Grief is a deeply studied psychological phenomenon, with various theories attempting to explain how individuals process and cope with loss. Two of the most widely recognized models are Elisabeth Kübler-Ross’s five stages of grief and J.

William Worden's four tasks of mourning. Kübler-Ross (1969)[5] proposed that individuals move through denial, anger, bargaining, depression, and acceptance as they come to terms with loss, while Worden (2018)[6] emphasized grief as an active process requiring individuals to complete four specific tasks. These frameworks have been extensively applied in grief counseling, trauma recovery, and media representations of loss, making them relevant for understanding and structuring the narrative of Iris. The animation follows The Man, a grieving father unable to accept his son Osiris's tragic suicide, and Iris, a whimsical fairy who later discovers she is the feminine soul of Osiris. Their intertwined emotional journey reflects the psychological complexities of mourning and acceptance.

The titular character Iris had embodied the emotional journey of grief as framed by Kübler-Ross's five-stage model. Initially, her innocence had been seen in her cheerful, carefree demeanor, symbolized by the bright, glowing colors of her body, unaware of her true identity. As the story had progressed, her enormous pain had emerged when she had discovered the devastating truth—that she had not been merely a guiding spirit, but a piece of the feminine soul of Osiris. Sadness and awareness of her true identity had overwhelmed her during the climax when the reality of her existence had shattered upon realizing she had been Osiris, mirroring the psychological pain that had often followed self-realization in grief and suicidal ideation. Lastly, acceptance had been achieved in the resolution as she had embraced who she was and had transformed into Osiris, symbolizing her acknowledgment of

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[5] Kübler-Ross, E. (1969). *On Death and Dying*. Macmillan Publishing Company.

[6] Worden, J. W. (2018). *Grief Counseling and Grief Therapy: A Handbook for the Mental Health Practitioner* (5th ed.). Springer Publishing Company

her past and her eternal presence bringing love and hope beside The Man in his everyday routine. This progression through Kübler-Ross's stages had reinforced the emotional weight of the animation and its exploration of identity and mourning.

While Iris had reflected an internalized grieving process, The Man had followed Worden's four tasks of mourning, portraying a more external struggle with loss. The first task, accepting the reality of the loss, had been his greatest challenge, as he had clung to denial and numbed himself with alcohol. His grief had been reflected in his dull gray color palette, symbolizing his inability to move forward. The second task, processing the pain of grief, had been portrayed through his struggle with despair and self-destruction, aligning with research that unresolved grief had led to unhealthy coping mechanisms. The third task, adjusting to a world without the deceased, had been complicated by his reluctance to let go of his son, highlighting the painful adjustment bereaved parents had often faced. The final task, finding an enduring connection while moving forward, had been visually and emotionally represented when Iris had embraced her transformation into Osiris, reassuring The Man that his son would always remain with him. This conclusion had provided a sense of closure, aligning with psychological insights on how the bereaved had maintained bonds with lost loved ones.

By integrating both Kübler-Ross's and Worden's theories, Iris had created a multi-layered depiction of grief that had resonated with real-life experiences of loss. Psychological research had suggested that narratives exploring bereavement could have provided catharsis for audiences, validating emotions and encouraging reflection. The contrast between Iris's vibrant fairy form and The Man's muted existence had visually reinforced the divide between avoidance and

confrontation of grief, emphasizing the spectrum of mourning experiences. The animation had ultimately served as both an artistic exploration of loss and a psychological study of healing, illustrating that grief had not been a process of forgetting but of transformation and acceptance.

In summary, Iris had effectively applied Kübler-Ross's and Worden's theories of grief to frame the emotional arcs of its protagonists. Through Iris's self-discovery and The Man's journey toward acceptance, the animation had highlighted the universal yet deeply personal nature of mourning. By using visual storytelling and psychological frameworks, Iris had served as a meaningful contribution to grief representation in animation, demonstrating how artistic media had bridged the gap between psychological theory and emotional storytelling. As research had suggested that fictional narratives could have shaped public perceptions of grief and mental health, Iris had stood as an example of how animation had deepened understanding of loss, healing, and the enduring connections between the living and the deceased.

CHAPTER III

TECHNICAL BACKGROUND OF THE STUDY

The capstone project 'Iris' had been an animated short film centered around a narrative that had delved into themes of grief, loss, hope, and remorse, highlighting the crucial need for acceptance prior to the onset of tragedy. It had merged aspects of western animation with a unique artistic approach, crafting a storytelling experience that had been both visually captivating and emotionally resonant.

The objective of the project had been to shed light on the difficulties that individuals had encountered while dealing with loss, while also underscoring the importance of mental health, particularly in the context of family dynamics. Through this animation, Iris had aimed to confront societal stigmas and had encouraged discussions about acceptance whether in the context of grief or in embracing one's uniqueness. By combining artistic expression with a meaningful narrative, the project had intended to create a significant impression on its viewers, fostering understanding and compassion for those who had faced loss and mental health challenges.

RESEARCH DESCRIPTION

As proponents of the capstone project, we had provided an overview of the study that had aligned the goals with a complete description and research methods.

A. **Description**

This capstone project had been an exploration of grief, bereavement, hope, and regret, emphasizing the importance of acceptance before tragedy. It had focused on a mixture

of western cartoon influences and our own stylistic approach, combining both light and dark atmospheres. The project had aimed to bring awareness to the acceptance of being different within the family while also highlighting the mental health struggles that individuals had faced after the death of a loved one.

B. **Research Methodology**

This study had taken a quantitative approach, using research methodologies designed to gain a more complete understanding of mental illness and its impact on viewers.

B.1 Quantitative Research

Quantitative data had been collected through online surveys, and observations from students who had watched the animation capstone project through test audience screening at the University of Iloilo-PHINMA. These strategies had provided information on the experiences, perspectives, and reactions of the audience. Respondents had added comments regarding their in depth understanding of the narrative, the animation style, and their reactions to the topic, which had reflected both stigma and acceptance in the context of today's situation.

Data Analysis

We applied a descriptive quantitative method using survey responses gathered during the test screenings. To process the demographic variables and audience reactions, we utilized **Frequency Count (f)** and **Percentage (%)** as our primary statistical tools. These measures allowed us to determine the distribution of responses across categories such as gender, course, and year level. By presenting the data in terms of frequencies and percentages, we were able to clearly identify

the majority and minority groups among the respondents and provide an accurate representation of their feedback on the animation project.

Formula for Percentage(%):

$$\% = \frac{f}{N} \times 100$$

RESEARCH DESIGN

The research design of this study had outlined the methodological framework used to investigate the impact and effectiveness of the capstone project Iris, a non-voice animation that had explored grief, bereavement, hope, and acceptance. This chapter had explained the quantitative research approach employed to gather meaningful insights into how audiences had perceived and emotionally engaged with the animation's themes. By using descriptive quantitative methodologies, including interviews, surveys, and observational analysis, the study had aimed to assess the animation's ability to encourage conversations about grief and mental health. In addition, the project had sought to determine how artistic storytelling in animation could have contributed to raising awareness and shaping public understanding of these sensitive topics.

The study's research design had solidified a structured approach to data collection and analysis, aligning with the overall goal of evaluating 'Iris' as both a creative project and an educational tool. Through quantitative inquiry, the study had captured the emotional responses of viewers, their interpretations of the narrative, and their engagement with the film's artistic and thematic elements. The following sections had outlined the qualitative data collection methods,

analytical tools, and ethical considerations that had guided the study's research process.

A. **Quantitative Data Collection**

Quantitative data collection for the animation capstone project had been a vital process for capturing audience emotions, perceptions, and nuanced impressions of the subject. Thorough data analysis, using appropriate statistical approaches, had enabled meaningful interpretation of the findings.

B. Data Analysis

The collected data from surveys had been analyzed to identify key themes such as grief and mental health, assess audience reactions, interpret basic statistics, compare responses before and after viewing, and gather feedback for improvement. This process had ensured that the animation had effectively conveyed its message and had resonated with viewers.

We gathered a total of 22 respondents during the test screenings conducted last October and November of 2025. These respondents represented the audience who viewed the animation prior to its premiere at the upcoming film festival, allowing us to collect their feedback and incorporate it into our final output. To analyze demographic variables such as gender, course, and year level, we employed **Frequency Count (f)** and **Percentage (%)** as our primary descriptive statistical tools. These methods enabled us to extract and present the distribution of responses clearly and effectively.

1. GENDER:

Frequency Count(f):

A. Male = 8

B. Female = 13

C. LGBT+ = 1

Percentage(%)

Formula:

$$\% = \frac{f}{N} \times 100$$

A. Male = $\frac{8}{22} \times 100 = 36.4\%$

B. Female = $\frac{13}{22} \times 100 = 59.1\%$

C. LGBT+ = $\frac{1}{22} \times 100 = 4.5\%$

Sample Table: Gender Distribution of Respondents

GENDER	FREQUENCY(f)	PERCENTAGE(%)
MALE	**8**	**36.4%**
FEMALE	**13**	**59.1%**
LGBT+	**1**	**4.5%**

2. COURSE:

Frequency Count(f):

A. BSIT = 21

B. BSPharma = 1

Percentage(%):

Formula:

$$\% = \frac{f}{N} \times 100$$

A. BSIT = $\frac{21}{22} \times 100 = 95.5\%$

B. BSPharma = $\frac{1}{22} \times 100 = 5.5\%$

Sample Table: Course Distribution of Respondents

COURSE	FREQUENCY(f)	PERCENTAGE(%)
Bachelor of Science of Information Technology	**21**	**95.5%**
Bachelor or Science in Pharmacy	**1**	**5.5%**

3. **YEAR LEVEL:**

Frequency Count(f):

A. 1st year = 10

B. 2nd year = 2

C. 3rd year = 3

D. 4th year = 7

Percentage(%)

Formula:

$$\% = \frac{f}{N} \times 100$$

A. 1st year = $\frac{10}{22} \times 100 = 45.5\%$

B. 2nd year = $\frac{2}{22} \times 100 = 9.1\%$

C. 3rd year = $\frac{3}{22} \times 100 = 13.6\%$

D. 4th year = $\frac{7}{22} \times 100 = 31.8\%$

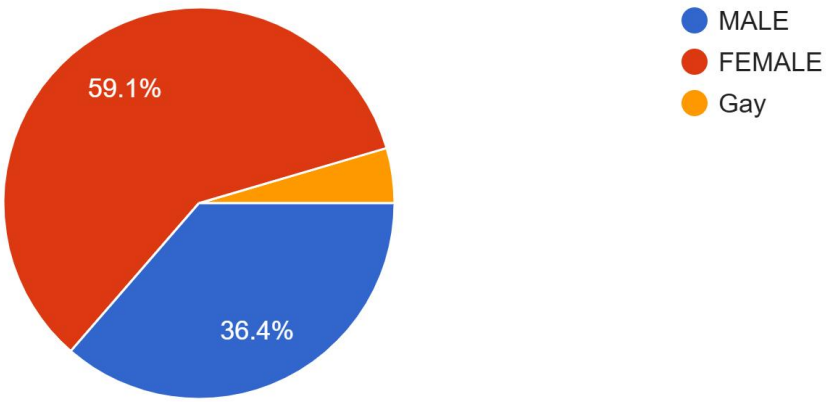
Sample Table: Year Level Distribution of Respondents

YEAR LEVEL	FREQUENCY(f)	PERCENTAGE(%)
First Year	10	45.5%
Second Year	2	9.1%
Third Year	3	13.6%
Fourth Year	7	31.8%

Data Visualization:

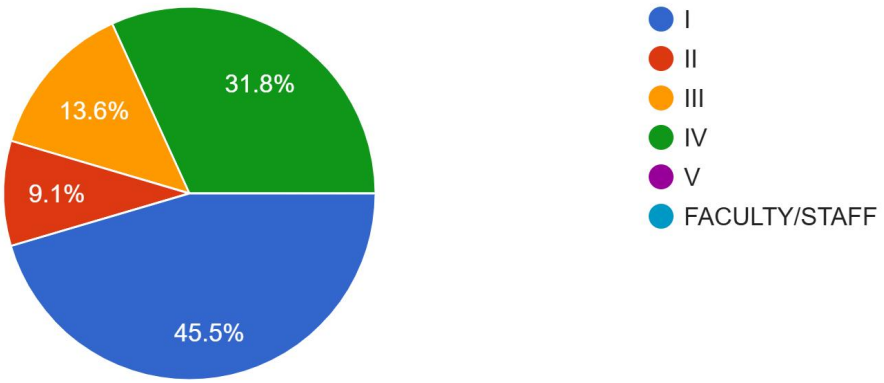
We used a **Pie Graph** to illustrate the distribution of responses. This allowed us to easily identify which categories represented the absolute majority and which reflected the least proportion among the respondents. By presenting the data in this visual format, we were able to highlight the demographic breakdown more clearly and provide a straightforward comparison of gender, course, and year level.

1. GENDER



2. COURSE

3. YEAR LEVEL



C. Results and Interpretation

The results of the capstone project 'Iris' showed that the animation effectively expressed themes of grief, acceptance, and mental health awareness. Viewers expressed strong emotional responses, finding the story relatable and impactful. Surveys indicated that the narrative and artistic style resonated well with audiences, highlighting the importance of family acceptance and emotional healing.

A. Narrative Survey

1 - lowest, 5 - highest

Rating	Frequency	Interpretation
1	0	Very Unsatisfactory
2	0	Unsatisfactory
3	7	Neutral

4	30	Satisfactory
5	73	Very Satisfactory

In five questions under this section, 7 respondents rated the narrative neutral, 30 rated it satisfactory, and 73 rated it very satisfactory. The high number of satisfactory ratings suggested that the film delivered its message effectively and resonated with audiences. Only a few rated it neutral, indicating minor areas for improvement in narrative pacing.

B. Animation Survey

1 - lowest, 5 - highest

Rating	Frequency	Interpretation
1	0	Very Unsatisfactory
2	4	Unsatisfactory
3	15	Neutral
4	27	Satisfactory
5	64	Very Satisfactory

Four respondents rated the animation unsatisfactory, 15 rated it neutral, 27 rated it satisfactory, and 64 rated it very satisfactory. The majority of respondents gave the highest rating, which indicated that the animation reached the

audience's level of satisfaction. The few neutral or lower ratings suggested slight inconsistencies or areas that could be refined.

C. Visual and Sound Design

1 - lowest, 5 - highest

Rating	Frequency	Interpretation
1	0	Very Unsatisfactory
2	1	Unsatisfactory
3	14	Neutral
4	33	Satisfactory
5	62	Very Satisfactory

One respondent rated this category unsatisfactory, 14 rated it neutral, 33 rated it satisfactory, and 62 rated it very satisfactory. Viewers appreciated the aesthetic appeal, color palette, and effective use of sound to enhance emotional impact. The small number of neutral ratings suggested minimal issues in sound clarity, but overall the category achieved a strong impression.

D. Overall Satisfaction

1 - lowest, 5 - highest

Rating	Frequency	Interpretation
1	0	Very Unsatisfactory
2	4	Unsatisfactory
3	2	Neutral
4	25	Satisfactory
5	79	Very Satisfactory

The film received overwhelmingly high ratings in overall satisfaction, with 79 respondents giving it the highest rating. A small number of unsatisfactory and neutral ratings reflected minor flaws, but the majority confirmed excellent viewer satisfaction

Surveys were largely positive, with praise for the animation’s visual style, heartfelt narrative, and deep storytelling. Observations from the University of Iloilo – PHINMA students showed high engagement, as viewers reflected on the emotional depth of the film. Respondents described this as touching and even heartbreaking, with many expressing that they loved the film as it was, noting that its unexpected ending and emotional storytelling resonated deeply. The project successfully portrayed the psychological aspects of grief using color symbolism and visual transitions, with the

contrast between Iris's bright form and The Man's muted tones effectively illustrating different stages of mourning.

Although a few viewers suggested improvements, such as refining character movements, enhancing voice- over clarity, and adding more emotional sound effects, the overall feedback confirmed that 'Iris' achieved its goal of raising awareness about grief and acceptance. The animation's storytelling and visuals helped spark discussions on mental health and family support, demonstrating the power of digital animation in expressing meaningful messages and leaving audiences with a poignant moral about love, forgiveness, and emotional healing.

COLLECTION METHODS

As the proponents of this capstone project, we had detailed the methodologies and analytical tools used in the study of digital animation. A well-structured approach to data collection and analysis had been essential for examining the intricacies of animation techniques, audience reception, and narrative effectiveness. By employing diverse research methods, the study had aimed to gather meaningful insights that had contributed to the refinement of animation quality, storytelling impact, and overall viewer engagement. Through systematic evaluation, the project had sought to enhance both the creative and technical aspects of digital animation, ensuring its effectiveness in conveying the intended themes and messages.

A. Collection Methods

1. Scriptwriting

It had been the process that had involved developing the narrative, dialogue, and structure of the story, ensuring

coherence and emotional depth in alignment with the project's themes.

2. Storyboarding

It had been the process of creating a visual representation of a script, scene, or concept through a series of illustrated panels. It had served as a blueprint for films and animations, helping creators plan out the sequence of events before production had begun.

3. Reenactment

It had been the process of recreating events that had described the interpretation from the scriptwriting and storyboarding, which had been used as references for the production in animation.

4. Character Designs and Assets Creation

It had been the process of developing visually appealing and functional characters, objects, environments, and other graphical elements for animation, films, and digital media. This study had focused on designing unique characters and assets that had aligned with the story, style, and purpose of the project.

5. Keyframing and Animation Process

It had been the study of how motion was created in animation using key poses, in-between frames, and timing principles. It had been essential for both 2D animation, ensuring that characters, objects, and environments had moved naturally.

6. Effects, Editing and Compositing

It had been the study of enhancing visual storytelling through special effects, editing, and layered composition in animation, film, and digital media. It had focused on combining different elements, refining the visual flow, and adding dynamic effects to create immersive and polished final outputs.

7. Sound and Music Design

It had been the study of making, modifying, and incorporating audio components into multimedia projects, animation, and movies to improve narrative and arouse emotions. It had focused on somber background music, creating immersive soundscapes, and coordinating audio and graphics to produce an engaging viewing experience.

B. Tools for Analysis

1. Animation Software

This had included the primary software such as Krita, which had been used for creating frame-by-frame animations, background assets, and character movement. It had provided essential tools for sketching, in-betweening, and applying visual effects, ensuring smooth and expressive animations that had aligned with the project's storytelling goals.

2. Editing and Compositing Software

These tools had been utilized to polish the animated sequences by incorporating sound, effects, and transitions. They had improved the final product by guaranteeing a smooth combination of visual components and background music, which had enhanced the overall cinematic effect of the animation.

3. Data Visualization Tools

To analyze audience engagement and research findings, data visualization tools had helped in organizing qualitative and quantitative feedback. These tools had allowed the team to interpret survey responses, viewer reactions, and social media interactions in a structured manner, leading to informed improvements in the animation.

4. Feedback Tools

Gathering audience feedback had been crucial for assessing the animation's effectiveness. Feedback tools, such as online surveys, structured interviews, and social media reactions, had provided valuable insights into how viewers had perceived the animation's themes, artistic choices, and emotional impact. These tools had contributed to refining the animation based on constructive criticism and audience reception.

SELECTION PROCESS OF DIGITAL TOOL

This capstone project had utilized *Krita* as the primary software for developing 2D digital animation due to its industry-standard capabilities and flexible features. As the project's proponents, the decision to use *Krita* had been based on its versatility and user-friendly interface, making it an ideal choice for both beginners and experienced animators. Over the years, digital arts students had widely adopted *Krita* for its comprehensive toolset, which had supported the animation process from sketching to final rendering. Its relevance to the project's goals had solidified efficient workflow management and high-quality animation production.

By integrating *Krita* into this capstone project, the focus had remained on achieving a smooth and adaptable animation process that had aligned with the creative and technical objectives of the study. The software's capability to handle frame-by-frame animation, along with its extensive brush engine and customization options, had allowed for the development of expressive and dynamic visuals. This choice had not only enhanced the animation quality but had also demonstrated the potential of open source tools in professional digital art and animation projects.

'KRITA' AS A PRIMARY TOOL

Krita had been chosen as the primary tool for this animation capstone project due to its versatility and industry-standard features, making it an ideal software for 2D digital animation. As an open-source platform, *Krita* had provided an extensive range of tools, including a powerful brush engine, customizable workspaces, and a dedicated animation timeline. Its frame-by-frame animation capabilities had allowed for fluid motion and expressive character movement, which had been crucial for delivering an emotionally impactful narrative. *Krita* had supported raster based drawing with advanced layer management, enabling artists to create detailed and visually compelling animation sequences. These features had made it a cost effective yet professional grade solution for independent animators and students working on capstone projects.

Advantages and Disadvantages of Using Krita

One of the key advantages of using *Krita* had been its accessibility as a free, open-source software, which had removed financial barriers for aspiring animators while still offering high quality features. Its compatibility with various file formats and seamless integration with other creative

tools had made it highly adaptable for animation workflows. *Krita*'s user-friendly interface and extensive online resources had provided an efficient learning curve, benefiting both beginners and experienced artists.

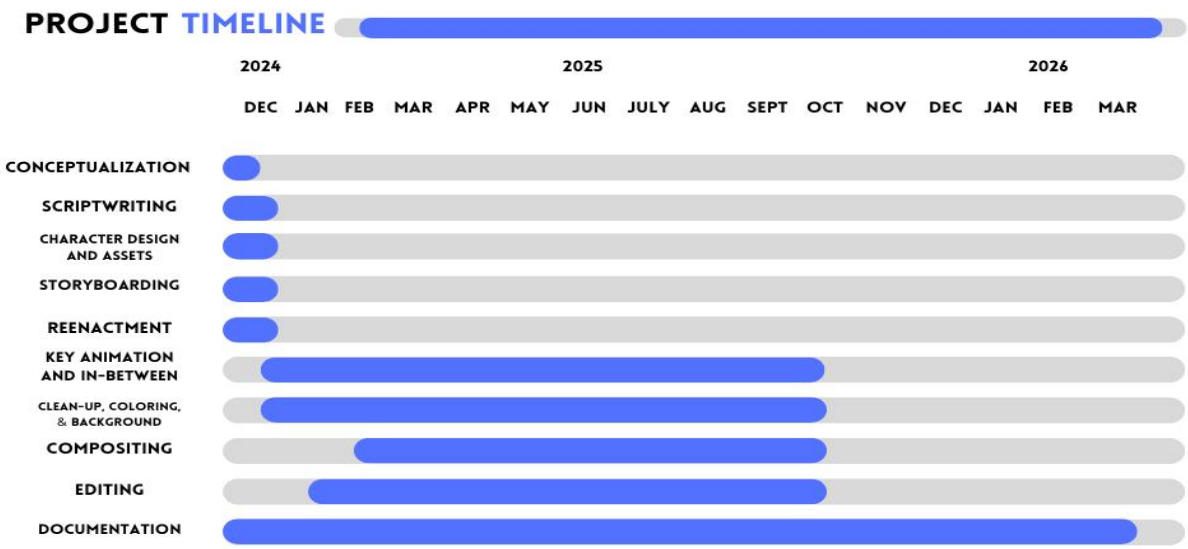
Despite its strengths, *Krita* had also presented limitations, such as occasional performance issues when handling large files and a lack of built-in audio synchronization for animations. These challenges had required strategic workflow management, but they had not outweighed the software's potential in delivering high-quality animation. By utilizing *Krita*, this capstone project had demonstrated how open-source tools could be leveraged to create professional and emotionally resonant storytelling in digital animation.

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Title: Iris - Capstone Project

Objective: 'Iris' had been created as a 2D animation that had related to real-life events experienced by families in contemporary society, including the acceptance of individuals belonging to the third genders and raising awareness of mental health issues such as bereavement, denial, regret, addiction, and depression, while also bringing hope and light to those living longer without their loved ones. The project had also served as a homage to Isao Takahata's 2015 anime and French animations, while presenting its own unique style of storytelling. The project had involved various stages, including concept development, character design, animation production, and post-production.

GANTT CHART



This represents the timeline 'Iris' Animation Capstone Project

Pre-Production Phase

1. **Conceptualization**

During the first four days, members had brainstormed and developed a unique storyline and visual style for the animated short film, ensuring that the concept had aligned with the overall vision.

2. **Scriptwriting**

The script had been carefully written over eleven days to outline the film's dialogue, actions, and overall structure, ensuring a clear narrative flow.

3. **Character and Asset Creation**

Over the course of nineteen days, the main characters and essential assets, such as props and

objects, had been designed and finalized to ensure that they had aligned with the film's aesthetic and narrative.

4. **Storyboard**

A seventeen day period had been dedicated to creating a storyboard that had visualized each scene, establishing composition, camera angles, and character placement to guide the animation process.

5. **Reenactment**

The scenes had been reenacted to gather accurate references for character movements and emotions, ensuring that the animation had been fluid and believable.

Production Phase

1. **Key Animation**

The key animations for the exposition scene had focused on establishing the primary actions, setting the tone for the film. The middle scene had been created to define the major actions and movements, providing a foundation for the rest of the sequence.

2. **In-Betweening**

In-betweening had filled in the gaps between keyframes, ensuring smooth transitions and realistic character movements.

3. **Clean-Up**

The cleanup phase had refined and polished the animation, ensuring consistency in line work and smoothness in movement.

4. **Coloring and Background**

Coloring and background design had brought the scenes to life, adding depth and atmosphere to the capstone's aesthetic.

5. **Compositing**

It had seamlessly integrated visual elements, such as characters, backgrounds, effects, and lighting, into cohesive and emotionally impactful scenes that had enhanced the overall storytelling and cinematic quality of the project.

6. **Editing**

The capstone project had undergone editing to solidify the timing, pacing, and transitions between scenes, ensuring that they had been seamless.

7. **Documentation**

Documentation had been created to record the development process, detailing key decisions and challenges that had been encountered during the production of the first chapter through the fifth. The documentation had continued throughout, covering the progress that had been made during the creation of Chapters one through five, and had provided an overview of the production process, analysis, and challenges.

TANGIBLE AND INTANGIBLE BENEFITS

Tangible

1. **Educational Resource** – 'Iris' can be used in mental health awareness campaigns,and research studies to educate people on grief, loss, and teenage suicide.
2. **Portfolio Enhancement** – The project strengthens your portfolio, showcasing your animation skills, storytelling abilities, and research-driven approach.
3. **Community Engagement** – The animation can be shared at mental health forums, or social media platforms, increasing outreach and engagement.
4. **Academic Contribution** – The project had served as a scholarly reference for future students and researchers in animation, psychology, and media studies.
5. **Archival Value** – The finished animation had become a permanent record of creative work, preserving cultural and social themes for future generations.

Intangible

1. **Emotional Impact & Awareness** – 'Iris' had helped spark conversations about grief, bereavement, and mental health, fostering understanding and empathy.
2. **Personal & Team Growth** – The project had allowed you and your team to develop skills in animation, storytelling, time management, and teamwork.
3. **Cultural & Social Contribution** – By focusing on mental health in the context of Filipino culture, 'Iris' had contributed to breaking the stigma surrounding mental health discussions.
4. **Inspiration for Future Creators** – Aspiring animators or storytellers had been encouraged to create meaningful projects tackling important social issues.

5. **Legacy & Lasting Impact** – Even after the capstone had been completed, 'Iris' had remained a valuable resource for discussions on mental health and emotional well-being.

RETURN OF INVESTMENT(ROI)

Creating a thorough plan is essential to successfully focusing on the audience, carrying out promotional activities and assessing the ROI. These are the specifics:

1. **Target Audience**

   This is essential to identify the demographic and psychographic characteristics of the target audience. These are the target audience of this short animation film:

   A. **General Audience**

   The capstone project '*Iris*' is intended for a broad audience, including individuals who have experienced loss or struggles with mental health. It aims to evoke empathy and awareness by presenting a relatable and emotionally engaging narrative.

   B. **Young Adults and Students**

   Young adults, particularly students, frequently experience emotional difficulties connected to stress, bullying, social pressure, anxiety, and suicide ideation. This film aims to shed light on mental health challenges and promote open talks about emotional well-being.

   C. **Animation and Film Enthusiasts**

   Viewers who appreciate storytelling through animation will find *Iris* compelling due to its visual

symbolism and emotional depth. The film highlights how animation can be a powerful medium for expressing complex human emotions.

2. Marketing Strategy

To effectively market 'Iris', the proponents considered the following strategies:

A. Teaser Posters and Trailers on Social Media

Utilizing teaser posters and trailers on social media is an effective strategy to generate anticipation and engagement for *Iris*. According to marketing research, visual content on platforms like Facebook significantly increases audience interaction.

B. University and School Screenings

Partnering with universities and schools to screen *Iris* can help educate students on the intersection of mental health and storytelling. Post-screening discussions and surveys for our capstone project can further engage young audiences and faculties in meaningful conversations.

3. Engagement Metrics

Track and analyze engagement data like views, likes, shares, and comments on social media networks, as well as surveys, following the premiere. This data may provide insight into the project's popularity, audience engagement, and potential for expansion.

4. Feedback and Reviews

Keep track of feedback and evaluations from both the target audience and industry specialists. Positive comments, prizes, or acknowledgment can signal the project's success and increase its long-term worth.

BREAKING DOWN THE RETURN OF INVESTMENT(ROI)

For the capstone project 'Iris', we compute the expenses and estimate the time required to recover from these expenses, we need to consider various factors and categories of expenses. Here is the breakdown:

1. Fixed Expenses
    a. Necessities/Groceries: PHP 1000 per month
    b. Gasoline: PHP 1000 per month
2. Variable Expenses
    a. Animation Production Costs: PHP 5,000.00
    b. Sound Design and Music Expenses: PHP 500.00
    c. Software and Equipment Purchases: PHP 30,000.00
    d. Marketing and Promotion Costs: PHP 0.00
3. Accrued Expenses
    a. Services rendered: Php1,000.00
    b. Goods received: Php 500.00
4. Total Expenses
    a. Fixed Expenses: Php450 per month
    b. Variable Expenses: Php14,000

c. Accrued Expenses: Php1,500

Total Expenses = Php450 x Number of Months + Variable Expenses + Accrued Expenses

To estimate the time required to recover from these expenses, it is essential to consider the revenue generation potential of the animation project. Here are some potential

CHAPTER IV

ANIMATION CONTENT

TITLE: IRIS

SYNOPSIS:

In a modest yet unkempt home, a lonely and depressed man had lived with his invisible fairy-guardian, Iris. Though unseen by him, Iris had quietly assisted with his daily routines: waking him, preparing coffee, and observing his repetitive habits of canned meals and beer in front of the television, which had greatly annoyed her. Their interactions had often led them near a mysterious "Blue Door," whose locked door had piqued Iris's curiosity. One day, while the man had slept on the couch and drunk, Iris had discovered the hidden key in his pants pocket and unlocked the room. Inside, she had found an untouched bedroom, and a photograph of the man with his smiling son behind the books. This revelation had triggered an existential crisis for Iris, who collapsed in pain as memories of the past began to surface.

The flashback had revealed the son's struggles as a closeted gay teenager, rejected by his boy crush and bullied by peers. Seeking comfort, he had turned to his father, only to be rejected in a heated argument where his father had disowned him. Devastated, the son had retreated to his room, haunted by shadows whispering escape, and unalived himself. In the present, the man had awakened to the sound of the broken picture frame and discovered a hidden letter from his son, expressing his pain, longing for acceptance, and need for his father's embrace. Overcome with regret, the father had wept uncontrollably, clutching the letter and photo. Watching from afar, Iris had transformed into the spirit of his son, Osiris, embracing him one final time before fading into the breeze

through the open window, leaving the father in grief yet touched by a fleeting moment of reconciliation.

OVERVIEW:

EXPOSITION SCENE:

- The film opens with a lonely house and a quiet morning, setting a tone of emptiness.
- Inside, a depressed father goes through his daily routine: brushing teeth, showering, eating, all done lifelessly and alone.
- Iris, a tiny guardian spirit, lives secretly under his bed. She takes care of him, even though he can’t see her.
- Through her gentle actions, we sense her deep affection and sadness for him.
- A Blue Door in the hallway repeatedly catches her attention, it’s mysterious, avoided by the father, and symbolizes something painful from the past.
- The scenes reveal the father’s grief, guilt, and emotional emptiness, while Iris quietly represents hope, care, and longing.

MIDDLE SCENE:

- One day, Iris discovers a key that belongs to the father and decides to open the Blue Door.
- She enters a dusty, untouched bedroom filled with books, medals, and trophies, it belonged to the father’s son, Osiris.
- In the bookshelf, Iris finds a photo of the father and Osiris, both smiling and proud.
- When she touches it, light bursts from the picture revealing that Iris is the spirit of Osiris, reborn as a guardian fairy watching over his father.
- This discovery transitions the story into the emotional backstory of how Osiris’ life ended.

CLIMAX SCENE:

- Flashbacks reveal Osiris' painful past.
- He was bullied and humiliated after confessing his love to another boy.
- When his father found out, they had a violent argument filled with anger, rejection, and hurt.
- The father shouted, "You are not my son anymore!" while Osiris accused him of being cruel and unloving.
- In despair, Osiris took his own life, leaving behind a rope and a shattered family.
- The visuals turn abstract — red, chaotic, and symbolic — representing Osiris' death and emotional suffering.
- From this chaos, the spirit of Iris is born — symbolizing forgiveness, rebirth, and the lingering love between father and son.

ENDING SCENE:

- Back in the present, the father wakes up hungover and realizes the Blue Door is open.
- He enters his son's old room and finds a hidden letter inside a broken photo frame.
- The letter contains Osiris' final words — an apology, a confession of pain, and a declaration of love
- As she embraces him, she transforms back into Osiris, hugging his father one last time.
- The father feels his son's presence — a moment of forgiveness and peace.
- The film closes with the father sitting quietly as the curtains blow in the wind, symbolizing release, healing, and acceptance.

SCRIPTWRITING:

EXPOSITION

WHITE.

FADE IN:

1. EXT. HOUSE - DAY 1 **1**

Zooms into the only house.
The sound of the bird chirping only in the background.

2. **INT. BEDROOM - DAY 2** **2**

The room is kind of messy.
Someone is sleeping in the bed.
Alarm clock rings.
Panning below and zooming into the small food can with ragged fabrics.

3. INT. BELOW OF THE BED - CONTINUOUS **3**

Iris wakes up in her bed that is made from a packaging squared-sized food can and ragged fabrics.
Iris is still sloppy.
Iris yawns.
The alarm rings louder.
She became annoyed.

4. **INT. BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS** **4**

Flies and clicks the “STOP” button of the alarm with an annoying face.

She sighs and suddenly smiles.

5. INT. BEDROOM **5**

Iris flies to the bed and appears to be a middle-aged man.
She holds her waist with both of her hands.
Thinking how to wake him up.
Light bulb eyes and a smile means she has an idea.
Iris flies near to the face of the Man.
Kissed his nose.

BLACK.

FADE IN:

The Man opens his eyes.
Blurry.
The Man stared at the white ceiling with no expression.
Iris is still staring at him near his eyes.
The Man cannot see Iris because she is a *spirit guardian fairy*.

6. **INT. BATHROOM** **6**

The Man and Iris brush their teeth in front of the mirror.
Iris brushes her teeth fast
While the Man brushes his teeth slowly like a worm.
His eyes look depressed with an eyebags.

7. INT. SHOWER AREA **7**

Iris is sitting at the edge of the sink waving her small legs while waiting.
But the Man's silhouette is just standing behind the shower curtain while the shower water runs onto him.
His face looked down and stared with his empty eyes for several minutes.

8. **INT. BEDROOM** **8**

The Man struggles to his shirt.
Iris helps him by pulling his shirt down to his torso

9. **INT. HALLWAY** **9**

The Man opens his door.
The look upon the other door in front of him.

***Showing the Blue Door*

The sorrow of his face while staring at it.
Iris flies and lands on the Man's shoulder.
She is confused and thinks: *'Why this door again?'*
Rolled her eyes while resting her chin on her right hand.
He taps something on the pocket of his shorts.
Iris observes it.
The Man walks out and closes his door.
He is going to the kitchen with a sorrowful face.
Iris is still curious and still staring at the Blue Door.
She stretched her neck in different directions while riding on his shoulder.

***Shows the Blue Door again.*

10. **INT. KITCHEN - DAY** **10**

The Man is heating the pan.
While Iris is beating the egg using whisk slowly using her both hands.
The Man looks at the bowl.
He holds the bowl then directly puts the whisk eggs into the heated pan.
Iris is confused and annoyed.
She stomps her little foot with an angry facial expression.

11. **INT. DINING AREA - DAY** **11**

The Man is sitting in the dining chair.
Eating slowly.
Still staring blankly in the window in front of him.
Stare to the Man who is staring blankly and starts crying.

12. **INT. FRIDGE** **12**

BLACK.

The Man opened the refrigerator.
He took the beer.
BLACK. with the sound of opening the cap.
A shadow of him in the kitchen drinking the beer.

BLACK.

Open the refrigerator again.
Took another beer.
BLACK. with the sound of opening the cap.
A shadow of him in the kitchen drinking the beer.

***REPEAT 2X ON THIS SCENE*

MIDDLE SCENES

13. **INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY** **13**

Iris wakes up while wrapping her arms around her legs.
She finds the Man sleeping on his couch while holding the beer.
The TV lights on only.
Beer falls to the ground and rolls into her feet.
She climbs into the couch's arm rest.
Saw the key which was going to fall in his pocket.
Key falls.
But Iris flies and saves it.
Holding like a stuffed animal.
Slowly landed to the ground while holding it.
Looking.
Observing the key.
Stares to the Blue Door.
Inhale.
Exhale.
Flies going to the door.

14. **INT. HALLWAY - DAY** **14**

She took the key into the door knob.
Clicks.
Iris holds both of her hands to open the door.
The Blue door opens slowly.
Creaks.
Iris is surprised and gasps.

***Shows an ordinary bedroom*

15. **INT. OTHER BEDROOM** **15**

Iris walks and observes the room.
Flies going to the bed.
Flies at the window and goes above the bookshelf.
Walking and observing.
She goes to observe the shelf.
The shelf is full of books and medals.

16. INT. BOOKSHELF **16**

Iris landed on the fourth out of five shelves.
She saw a picture frame hiding in the dark.
She pulls out.
She is surprised.
Reveals the picture of the Man and the Son, smiling.

Zooms into the picture captured during the graduation ceremony with the son had a lot of awards pinned and medals in his white robe.

Iris' eyes opened.
Her heart beats fast.
She gets anxious.
Her tears fell on her cheeks.
She slowly touches the picture frame's glass.
Sparks.
The light goes into her body.
Iris is stunned.
Zooms flashes into her eyes.

WHITE.

17. **EXT. SCHOOL - BACKSTORY** **17**

FADES IN:

There were two guys talking at the back of the school.
Osiris, the gay student handed over the letter.
His crush smirked and told him:

Crush:
"Ano to?!
Niloloko mo ba ako, Osiris?
Akala ko matinong tao ka.
Lalaki ka.
Tapos ako gusto mo?"

His crush slaps the letter Osiris's hand.
Osiris was shocked.
Stunned.

Crush:
"Wag mo na akong lapitan.
NAKAKAHIYA KA!"

He cannot hold his tears.
Anxious and the tension floats.
Until a girl is sneaking to the situation and eventually smiled.

18. INT. SCHOOL HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS **18**

Osiris is walking on the hallway.
Some of the students in red silhouettes are laughing at him.
Osiris stayed stone-face.

Osiris:
"Bakit ganun?"

19. **INT. CLASSROOM - CONTINUOUS** **19**

Abstracted images floating into the environment of the gay.
Laughing echoes in the background.
He is sitting at the front of gay slurs written on his table.

Osiris:
"Wala naman akong ginawang masama…
Gusto ko lang maramdaman na,
Tao rin ako."

20. **INT. CLASSROOM - CONTINUOUS** **20**
Closed up into his head.
Someone throws him a paper.

Osiris:
"Kung ganito ang kapalit sana…"

21. INT. ABSTRACTED IMAGES - CONTINUOUS **21**
Red.
Camera behind Osiris.
Crying.
He huddled into his knees.

Osiris:
"hindi ko na lang sinabi kung ano naramdaman ko…"

22. INT. ABSTRACTED IMAGES - CONTINUOUS **22**
Black silhouette Osiris is holding his head.
Eyes twisted. Rage. Depressed.

Osiris:
"KUNG ANO AKO!"

(flash Red and White color font)

23. INT. ABSTRACTED IMAGES - CONTINUOUS **23**

Camera focus on his cheeks down to his neck.
Red tears falling.
Red into White Tears falling.
Tears turned into Osiris's white silhouette.
He still huddled into his knees.
Crying.
People laughing in the background.

Osiris:
"PAPA KAILANGAN KITA!"

FADES OUT:

BLACK.

24. **INT. HOUSE - NIGHT** **24**

The gay was revealed to be the son of the Man.
The Man is standing inside the house while holding the draft letter of the son.
Door opened.

25. **EXT. OUTSIDE OF THE HOUSE - CONTINUOUS(NIGHT)** **25**

The silhouette of the Son and the Man are having an argument.
Their echoes can be heard outside the house.

26. **INTERNAL LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS** **26**

Zooms into their mouths and eyes.
Zooms into the mouth of the Man.

Man:
"WALA AKONG ANAK NA BAKLA!"

Osiris felt shocked.
Angry and said:

Osiris:
"Alam ko na…
Alam ko na hindi mo ako gusto
Kung bakit…
INIWAN TAYO NI MAMA!"

The Man slaps him hard.
The sound of the slap echoes in the background

BLACK.

The Son holds his face.
Catching his breath.

Osiris:
"Wala akong amang mapanakit na kasing tulad mo."

Upset.
Zooms to Man's eye.
Osiris ran into his room.
The Man shocked for what he did.

Man:
"OSIRIS!"

BLACK.

27. **INTERNAL SON'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** **27**

The Son is staring into the opened window.
Sitting at the front of his table with a graduation picture with his father.

Osiris:
"Sawa na ako…"

Still in shock.
Deep breath.
Heart pounds.

Osiris:
"Kung ganito lang palagi ang aking buhay…"

Frowns.
Tears into his face.
Faced on us.

Osiris:
"Saan pa ako pupunta?"

Osiris opened his drawer and got the yellowish rope

Osiris:
"AYOKO NANG…"
(twitchy red font)

Focusing to the rope, then focus to Osiris getting ready to hold it.

Osiris:
"Mabuhay."

BLACK.

In the distance a blurred scene reveals the Son's silhouette unalived.
Rope tightened sound.
A red particle went outside of his body and flies.
Tense from the colorful background into red.
Flash lights.

RED.

28. **INT. ABSTRACTED - CONTINUOUS** **28**

FADES IN:

A sphere appears with the sound of the heartbeat.
Zooms in with the sound of the woman whispering Iris' name repeatedly.
The sphere breaks revealing the birth of 'Iris'.
The picture frame falls into the ground.
Glass breaks.
Iris falls also.
Zooms out to the bedroom.

BLACK.

FADES OUT:

==========

CLOSING/CONCLUSION SCENES

29. **INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY** **29**

Glass breaks heard in the living room.
The Man wakes up.

He holds his head from being drunk.
He pats his pocket.
He is shocked the key is gone.
He looks below the couch.
He was so scared to lose it.
The Man looks at the Blue Door open.
Shock.
He ran it over.

30. **INTERNAL SON'S BEDROOM - DAY** **30**

He opens the door.
He was stunned that the room was open.
He looks angry.
Walk slowly.
He stumbles in the glass.
He looks down and holds the broken picture frame.

***Zooms out the man holding it while Iris is beside the broken glass*

The Man caresses the frame and wants to take out the photo.
He unlocks the frame.
He discovers something.
A letter.
Curious, he opens it.
He sits in the bed and reads the letter.

***Showed the letter written by the son*

THE SON
"Dear Papa,

I've tried to carry on, tried to bear all the pain and loneliness on my own, but I'm not strong enough to hold on anymore. Every day at school, I am met with hurtful words and looks, reminders that I am not accepted simply for being who I am. Being bullied for something so deeply a part of me, something I can't change, has been unbearable. Then there's the heartbreak I carry in secret, the love I couldn't show or share openly. I've felt so alone, and I hoped that one day I could come to you, that maybe I could feel the comfort of your arms around me. But after our last argument, that hope feels shattered beyond repair.

I'm sorry for everything, Papa. I wish I could have been the son you wanted or, at the very least, someone you could understand. My heart aches for the relationship we never had, and I wish things had been different. I wanted you to know that it's not your fault—it's just that I've been carrying this weight for so long, and I don't have the strength left to keep going.

Even if I never found the courage to say it out loud but…
I love you.

Love,
Osiris"

The tears fall into the letter.
The Man clutches the letter into his chest.
Crying.

Man:
"OSIRIS, I'M SORRY!
Sana mapatawad mo ako sa ginawa ko sa'yo."

The Man is still clutching the letter while swaying.
Iris wakes up and holds her forehead.
Shakes her head.
Grunts.
She heard the cry of the Man.

Man:
"Mahal na mahal kita, anak."

She is concerned.
She slowly stands although still in pain.
She still holds her stomach from the pain she had.
Iris stared at the Man again who cried.
Iris was sad.
Tears fell into her face.
She flies slowly to the Man.
She lands into his shoulder.
Pats the Man.
Still worrying.
She goes into his ear and whispers something:

Iris:
"Huwag kang mag-alala, Papa
Nandito lang ako sa iyong tabl habangbuhay."

She hugs his shoulder and cries.
Then she spread her arms widely.
The right arm of the son appears at the right side of the Man's shoulder.
Iris slowly disappeared and slowly turned into Osiris.
Osiris hugged his Father tightly.

Osiris:

"I LOVE YOU PAPA."

The Man shocks.
Gasping.
Feeling there is someone with him.
He looks at the frame in his hands but there is no letter.
The window suddenly opens.
The Man checks behind him.
The Man still sits in the bed.
Staring.
While the curtains blowing in the wind.

BLACK.

IRIS Title

END CREDIT SCENES

END

PRE-PRODUCTION PHASE

Presentation of the Design and Genre of the Animation

The animation short film Iris had belonged to the Drama-Fantasy genre, focusing on emotional storytelling and inner transformation by blending realistic human struggles with subtle magical elements. Its stylized art style had emphasized expressive shapes and colors to highlight emotion. Characters had been drawn with elongated features and soft edges to enhance their personalities: the father's heavier frame and shadowed palette had represented his emotional weight, Iris's vivacious actions had symbolized hope in contrast to despair, and Osiris's slender figure with lighter tones had reflected fragility and sensitivity. The world

design had leaned toward gentle color transitions, blending warm and cold tones to mirror the balance between grief and hope. Animation techniques had included frame-by-frame 2D animation with slow-paced motion to emphasize atmosphere, while lighting and shadow had played a crucial role in portraying emotions. Muted yellow-grays and reddish watercolor-style visuals had been used during moments of conflict and regret.

The capstone film Iris had drawn inspiration from several acclaimed animated works that exemplified emotional depth, visual symbolism, and the expressive potential of both traditional and digital animation. These references—The Tale of the Princess Kaguya (Studio Ghibli, 2013), The Boy, the Mole, the Fox and the Horse (2022), If Anything Happens I Love You (2020), and The Last Summer by Gobelins (2019)—had served as creative foundations that shaped the project's visual style, tone, and narrative direction. Each reference had contributed to the film's goal of portraying grief, acceptance, and emotional reconciliation through evocative staging and composition, ultimately guiding the capstone toward a deeply human and emotionally resonant storytelling experience

(References used in the capstone project: 'The Tale of Kaguyahime'(left-top), 'The Boy, The Mole, The Fox and The Horse'(right-top), 'If Anything Happens I Love You'(left-bottom), 'The Last Summer'(right-bottom))

The *Tale of the Princess Kaguya* had influenced the film's art direction and expressive minimalism during the flashback scenes. Its watercolor-like textures, fluid brushwork, and emotional character animation had guided Iris in developing a hand-drawn aesthetic that emphasized vulnerability and purity. Similarly, *The Boy, the Mole, the Fox and the Horse* had inspired Iris's gentle pacing and emotional intimacy, reflected in the relationship between the father and the spirit of his son. The calm tone, soft lighting, and natural compositions of the reference had reinforced the theme of hope and human connection amidst despair.

Meanwhile, *If Anything Happens I Love You* had profoundly shaped the film's visual storytelling and emotional framing. Its use of silence, shadows, and negative space as emotional devices had influenced how Iris portrayed loss and longing through subtle gestures and light transitions rather than dialogue. Lastly, *The Last Summer* had inspired the color symbolism and emotional progression within Iris, using lighting shifts and atmospheric tones to represent the transition from grief to forgiveness.

These references had provided a multidimensional foundation that had enhanced both the storytelling and visual design of Iris. By merging the poetic visuals of Princess Kaguya, the warmth of The Boy, the Mole, the Fox and the Horse, the emotional rawness of If Anything Happens I Love You, and the stylistic storytelling of The Last Summer, the film had achieved a unified aesthetic that elevated its themes of redemption, acceptance, and enduring love.

Impression and Illustration of Character Design

We had used reenactment as a reference to study real-life emotions and body language. This approach had helped us capture natural movements, gestures, and expressions, making each scene feel more grounded and believable. By observing and recreating authentic human behavior, the animation had achieved a sense of realism that had complemented its stylized art direction and emotional themes.

(Reenactment References)

The visual representations of the main characters had served as essential components in communicating the narrative's emotional and thematic depth. Each design had emphasized the individuality and psychological nuances of the characters through their posture, attire, and distinguishing features. The first character's reserved and slouched stance had conveyed a sense of internal struggle and guilt, reflecting the burden of past mistakes. In contrast, Iris's

ethereal appearance highlighted by her light-toned costume, radiant aura, and expressive pose had symbolized purity, hope, and transcendence. The final character's heavy form and seated position had illustrated exhaustion and remorse, reinforcing the emotional weight that had underpinned the story's tone.

These visual cues had created a cohesive narrative identity that had allowed the audience to discern personality and emotional state at a glance, even in the absence of dialogue. By relying on carefully constructed visual symbolism, the film had achieved a deeper resonance, ensuring that the characters' emotions and struggles had been communicated effectively without the need for explicit verbal expression.

(Dynamic poses of each characters)

The character designs had demonstrated the thoughtful integration of visual storytelling principles and psychological symbolism. The contrast in color palettes, posture, and clothing styles had not only differentiated each figure but had also visually articulated the emotional dynamics between them. The simplicity of the designs had directed attention to gesture and expression, emphasizing the narrative's focus on human emotion and transformation. Through these illustrations, the creators had effectively merged

aesthetic composition with narrative purpose—transforming character visuals into instruments of storytelling that had embodied grief, redemption, and emotional healing. In this sense, the designs had transcended their visual form to become representations of each character's inner world, grounding the film's abstract emotional themes in a tangible visual language.

Highlighting the Important Details of Each Characters

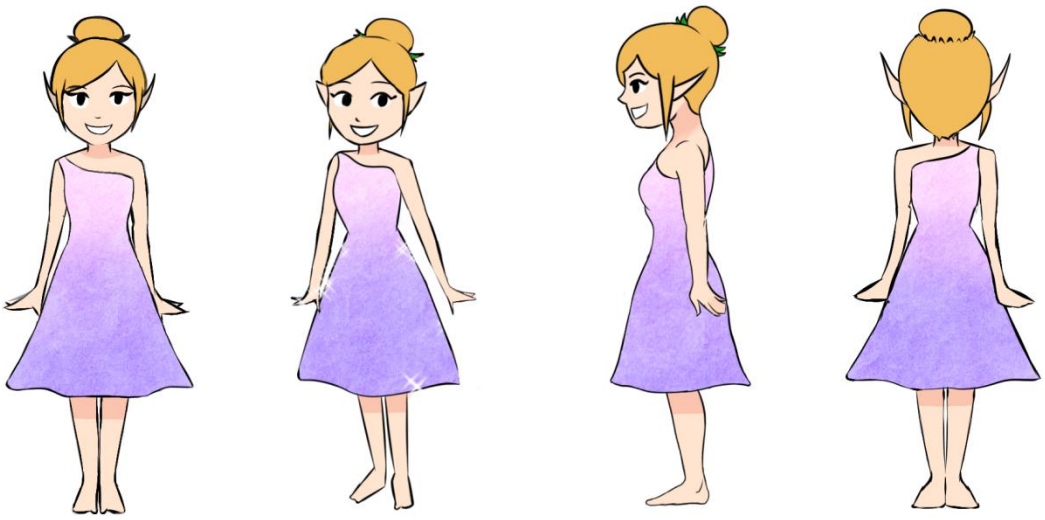
(Expressions)

Each character's emotions depicted in the capstone project had been critical in communicating emotional depth and narrative purpose through visual design. Each character's facial expression, body proportion, and outfit aspect had been carefully designed to portray their internal emotions and personality qualities. The protagonist's reactions, ranging from worry and perplexity to guilt, had reflected his inner anguish and emotional fragility. In contrast, Iris's brilliant and flowing emotions, combined with her ethereal features and radiant clothing palette, had conveyed empathy, compassion, and otherworldly elegance. Meanwhile, the father's restrained yet significant emotions had conveyed anguish and emotional restraint, anchoring the drama in realism and human vulnerability. These expressive differences had successfully built character identification and increased viewer empathy,

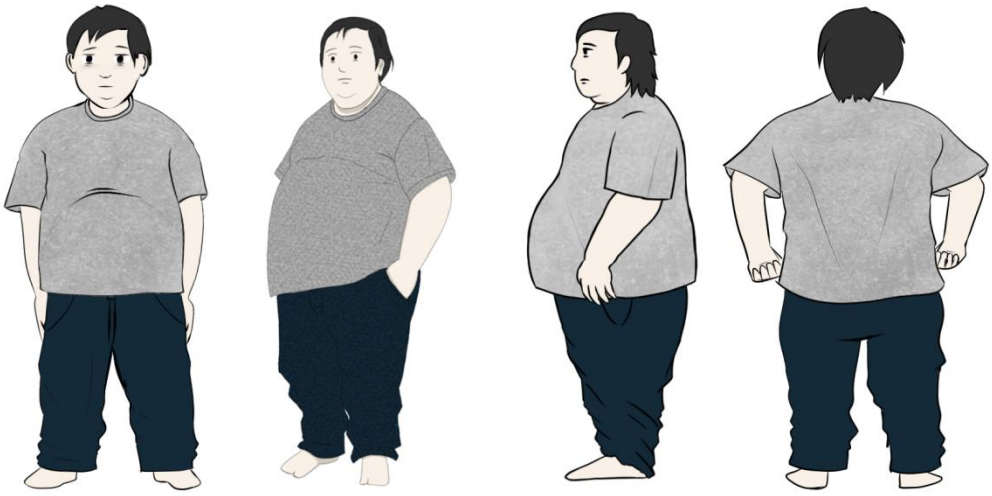
converting minor facial expressions into potent narrative weapons that had conveyed emotion beyond words.

TURNAROUND SHOTS OF THE CHARACTER DESIGN

IRIS:



THE MAN/THE FATHER:



OSIRIS:

Each character in Iris had been designed with careful attention to facial expression, body proportion, and costume to visually communicate their personality and emotional depth. Iris, the fairy, had been designed with a soft color palette and gentle gradients to symbolize hope and light. Her expressive eyes, small frame, and delicate gestures had enhanced her ethereal presence, while her rainbow trail had visually represented emotional warmth and spiritual guidance. The Father, in contrast, had exhibited heavier body proportions, tired posture, and subtle facial sagging with prominent eyebags visual cues of grief, guilt, and emotional exhaustion. His plain, oversized gray shirt and dark pants had reflected his mundane and sorrowful existence, grounding his character in realism. Osiris, the son, had been depicted with slender proportions, neat attire, and large round glasses, highlighting his gentle and intellectual personality. His youthful features and calm facial expressions had created a

sense of innocence and vulnerability, contrasting the Father's weariness. These design choices had established visual storytelling that had complemented the film's emotional narrative, ensuring that each character's appearance had reinforced their symbolic role in the journey toward acceptance, forgiveness, and emotional healing.

DESCRIPTION OF THE CHARACTERS

1. **Iris** - the story's main protagonist, a fairy guardian of the Man (eventually known as 'the Father'), who is distraught after losing something. Despite the fact that she is invisible to the Man, she assists him with his routines and guides him through his home. She was happy, moody when things didn't go her way, intrigued about 'Blue Door', and caring. In a subsequent story, she was revealed to be the female spirit of the Man's deceased gay son, a 'female within the teenager boy's body'.

APPEARANCE

She is inspired by Joy from Inside Out, Ember Lumen from Elemental, Tinker Bell from Disney's Peter Pan, and Princess Kaguya from Kaguyahime no Monogatari. Bright Pale Yellow effects when she flies; Long blonde with bright red hair strips and twinkle blue eyes, wearing light pink dress, blunt hands and feet. Light brown is her skin color.

2. **The Man/the Father** - a depressed, quiet, and regretful second protagonist. The key-keeper of the 'Blue Door' was Iris curious about. It revealed that he is distraught over losing someone. He watches TV all day and night, always sits on the small couch, eating delivered fast foods, and drinking beer

for his sobriety. In the latter event, the 'Blue Door' was actually his dead son's bedroom full of memories from a kid to teenager. He regretted what he did to his son, he did not acknowledge after he learned that he is gay and got into a huge argument that could cause the end of life. In the last scene, he regretfully apologizes while hugging his son's shattered picture frame.

APPEARANCE

He is inspired by the Father from Anything Happens I Love You, Charlie from Aranovsky's The Whale and Massimo Marcovaldo from Disney's Luca; Black hair, aging 45-year old pale-skinned, big sized 6 '0 man. Wearing a gray t-shirt and brown pants.

3. **Osiris** - the mysterious person later known as the dead son of the Man. He is gay that his father did not acknowledge after he knew the truth. He was rejected by his boy crush, shattered by peer pressure, bullying, and family problems with no support from the only family he had, he ended his life by hanging. At the end of the story, revealing Iris' male physical body. As Iris turned into son's spirit, he hugged his father at the back where he accepted his greatest fault.

APPEARANCE

He had black korean-styled hair, slim average height 16-year old boy; Wearing white polo shirt and black pants.

RELATIONSHIPS OF THE CHARACTERS

Each character in 'Iris' was carefully conceptualized to reflect their emotional journeys and the central themes of grief, redemption, and forgiveness.

Iris, the fairy, serves as the visual embodiment of hope and emotional reconciliation. Designed with soft, radiant colors and flowing movements, she symbolizes purity and spiritual guidance. Her delicate gestures and luminous design represent her role as a bridge between the spiritual and emotional realms. Motivated by compassion, Iris seeks to guide both the Father and Osiris toward peace and acceptance, serving as a silent witness to their reconciliation. Through her presence, the film visualizes the transformative power of empathy and forgiveness.

Osiris, the son, is portrayed with slender body proportions, calm facial features, and youthful clothing that suggest innocence and sensitivity. His design emphasizes fragility and emotional depth, enhanced by his expressive eyes and gentle posture. Osiris's motivation lies in his longing for acceptance—from his father and from society—for his true identity. His relationship with his father is strained by misunderstanding and rejection, symbolizing the internal conflict of self-identity and belonging. Throughout the film, Osiris evolves from a character burdened by emotional pain into one who finds peace in expressing love and forgiveness, even beyond life itself.

The Father/The Man stands as the emotional anchor of the story. His heavier build, muted color palette, and slouched posture visually communicate grief, guilt, and emotional fatigue. His motivations are rooted in regret and the painful realization of his lost connection with his son. Initially distant and emotionally repressed, the Father's journey reflects the struggle of acceptance and self-redemption. His development unfolds as he confronts memories of Osiris and his own mistakes, guided by Iris's symbolic presence. By the film's conclusion, his transformation from denial to forgiveness signifies emotional healing and closure, visually

and narratively uniting the film's themes of love, loss, and reconciliation.

Discussion of Staging and Composition in Relation to the 12 Principles of Animation

The short animated film 'Iris' had utilized thoughtful staging and composition to communicate its emotional story about grief, forgiveness, and the connection between a father and his departed son, Osiris, who had reincarnated as a small guardian spirit named Iris. Every shot and movement had been designed not only for visual beauty but also to express the inner struggles of the characters. The use of the 12 Principles of Animation had reinforced the tone, pacing, and emotional rhythm of the film:

1. **Squash and Stretch**

This principle had been used to bring life and flexibility to Iris' movements. Her body had gently squashed and stretched when flying or reacting, showing her spirit-like energy and innocence. In contrast, the father's movements had remained stiff and heavy, emphasizing his emotional burden.

2. **Anticipation**

Small anticipatory actions had prepared viewers for major emotional moments. For example, Iris had paused and inhaled before opening the Blue Door — heightening suspense and curiosity. Similarly, the father's trembling hands before opening his son's letter had created emotional build-up.

3. **Staging**

The staging had been designed to clearly convey emotion and story direction. Each frame had used light, space, and positioning to highlight feelings — such as the father framed

alone in dim light to show emptiness, or Iris surrounded by bright light to symbolize purity. The "Blue Door" had been centrally staged as a recurring symbol of guilt and memory, drawing the viewer's attention each time it appeared.

4. **Straight Ahead Action and Pose to Pose**

Iris' flowing, natural movements (like flying and spinning) had used straight-ahead animation for organic, spontaneous motion. The father, however, had used pose-to-pose animation to show slow, deliberate actions — like brushing his teeth or holding the letter.

5. **Follow Through and Overlapping Action**

Iris' hair and dress had followed through naturally as she flew or turned, adding grace and believability. Even her emotional gestures, like her tiny hand movements when comforting the father, had felt continuous.

6. **Slow In and Slow Out**

The timing of movements — such as Iris slowly approaching the father before hugging him — had used gradual acceleration and deceleration to emphasize emotion. Likewise, when the father had read the letter, the pacing had slowed, letting the audience absorb the pain and realization.

7. **Arcs**

Natural arcs had been used throughout Iris' movements — in her flight paths, gestures, and hair flow — to maintain visual harmony and fluidity. Even the father's small motions, like sitting down or reaching for the letter, had followed subtle arcs that mirrored human behavior.

8. **Secondary Action**

Small background or supporting actions had deepened characterization, like Iris fixing her hair before helping the father, or the father glancing at the Blue Door during

breakfast. These secondary actions had communicated inner feelings without dialogue.

9. **Timing**

Precise timing had helped express mood transitions. Fast pacing had been used during Iris' cheerful moments, while slower timing had dominated the father's scenes, showing grief and fatigue. The contrast had created rhythm and balance between hope and despair.

10. **Exaggeration**

Exaggeration had been used symbolically, like Iris' expressive reactions (wide eyes, glowing body, and big gestures) — to make her emotions visible despite her small size. The father's exaggerated stillness, on the other hand, had become powerful in its restraint.

11. **Solid Drawing**

Each scene's composition had followed strong silhouettes and clear poses to maintain balance and clarity. Lighting and framing had emphasized depth — for example, Iris in the foreground with the father blurred in the background, or vice versa, ensuring the audience had always known where to look.

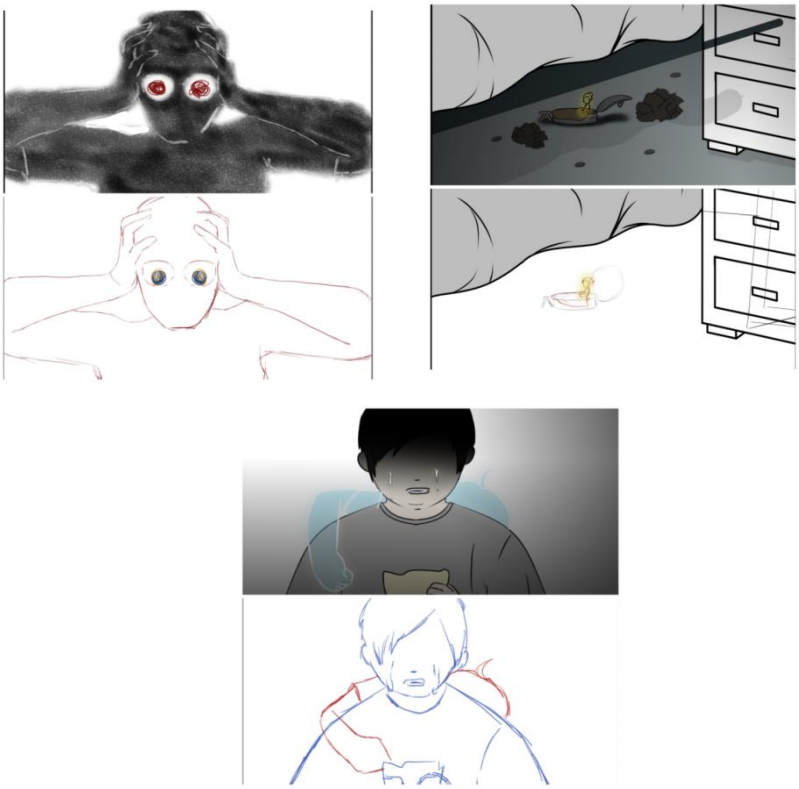
12. **Appeal**

Iris' design, small, luminous, and soft-featured, had been intentionally appealing to evoke empathy and warmth. The father's rough, tired appearance had contrasted her purity, making their interaction emotionally striking. The compositions had often used symmetry and lighting contrast to highlight this relationship.

PRODUCTION PHASE

Key Drawings of Character Design with Action Poses

The key drawings presented in capstone project had functioned as the visual foundation that had encapsulated the emotional and psychological dimensions of the narrative. Through the application of dynamic action poses and expressive character movements, these drawings had illustrated the internal struggles and emotional progression of the characters. Each key frame had been deliberately structured to correspond with the tone and emotional intent of the film, portraying the father's anguish and remorse, Iris's ethereal compassion and vitality, and Osiris's quiet longing that had eventually evolved into understanding and acceptance. The emphasis on body language, facial expressions, and gesture design had enabled the depiction of complex emotions without reliance on dialogue. This approach had demonstrated how key drawings had served not merely as technical components of animation, but as critical tools for visual storytelling that had translated intangible emotions into a tangible, visual form.



(Key Poses and its Clean Up)

Moreover, the key drawings had exemplified the practical application of the 12 Principles of Animation, particularly anticipation, exaggeration, and appeal, which had contributed to the realism and emotional rhythm of the sequences. The juxtaposition of the father's restrained, heavy movements against Iris's fluid and radiant motions had underscored the film's thematic contrast between despair and hope. Compositional elements such as line weight, framing, and staging had been strategically employed to direct viewer attention toward moments of emotional significance. Through this methodical integration of design principles and narrative intent, the animation had effectively conveyed themes of grief, redemption, and healing. Consequently, the key drawings in "Iris" had served as both artistic and analytical evidence of the filmmakers' capacity to utilize animation as a medium for psychological and emotional expression.

Staging and Layout Themes and Design of the Scenes

The staging and layout of the scenes had effectively enhanced the storytelling by using contrasting lighting, balanced compositions, and symbolic placement of objects to reflect the characters' emotions and narrative tone. Warm and muted colors had conveyed nostalgia and melancholy, while cooler tones and shadowed spaces had emphasized isolation and tension. Through careful framing and depth, each scene had visually communicated emotional progression, creating a

cohesive and compelling visual narrative that had strengthened the overall impact of the animation.

Visual Themes and Design Elements in Establishing Atmosphere and Emotional Tone

1. The underlying suspense of *"Blue Door"* had attracted an audience's attention.
2. Using a yellow tone in compositing had shown a melodramatic scene of the Father's vulnerable expression.
3. The shift of art style in the flashback had given a thrilling mood as the climax.
4. A clear composition with less black tone had provided a mood that symbolized peace and closure.

Illustrations of Backgrounds in the Scenes

The backgrounds had depicted a variety of indoor settings, a bedroom, bathroom, and kitchen, all designed with realistic yet stylistically consistent details. Each environment had reflected the mood and personality of the characters while visually reinforcing the narrative themes.

(Backgrounds used)

1. **Bedroom Scene** – the rooms had been minimalist but expressive. The use of cool blue tones had suggested calmness, isolation, or melancholy, while the presence of small personal items (lamp, books, plush toy, desk) had given a sense of lived-in space and individual routine. The difference in tidiness between rooms had hinted at emotional contrast — one neat and orderly, another cluttered and chaotic — symbolizing mental or emotional states.

2. **Bathroom Scene** – the shadowed figure behind the shower curtain had created a sense of mystery and vulnerability. The muted color palette and dim lighting had added to the realism and psychological tension, suggesting introspection, secrecy, or emotional struggle.

3. **Kitchen Scene** – the cracked tiles, unwashed dishes, and scattered items had evoked a sense of neglect or weariness. The background design had subtly conveyed realism and emotional weight, as if the environment itself had told part of the story.

The backgrounds in this capstone project had played a vital role in shaping the emotional atmosphere and enhancing the storytelling. Each scene had been carefully designed with attention to lighting, color, and spatial arrangement to mirror the characters' emotions and circumstances. The dim, muted tones of the bedroom and kitchen had created a somber, reflective mood, while the warmer lighting and organized spaces had suggested moments of clarity or emotional warmth. These visual contrasts had helped communicate shifts in the narrative without relying heavily on dialogue, allowing viewers to feel the emotional weight of each moment.

(Showcase illustrations or images of the backgrounds used in various scenes,highlighting their design and atmosphere)

The backgrounds had complemented the characters by grounding them in realistic and expressive environments that had reflected their internal states. The worn textures, cluttered surfaces, and subtle light sources had evoked a sense of authenticity, making the scenes relatable and immersive. By visually aligning the setting with the character's journey, the backgrounds had acted as an extension of the story itself — emphasizing themes of isolation, healing, and self-reflection. This seamless integration of design and narrative had strengthened the overall visual storytelling and emotional impact of the animation.

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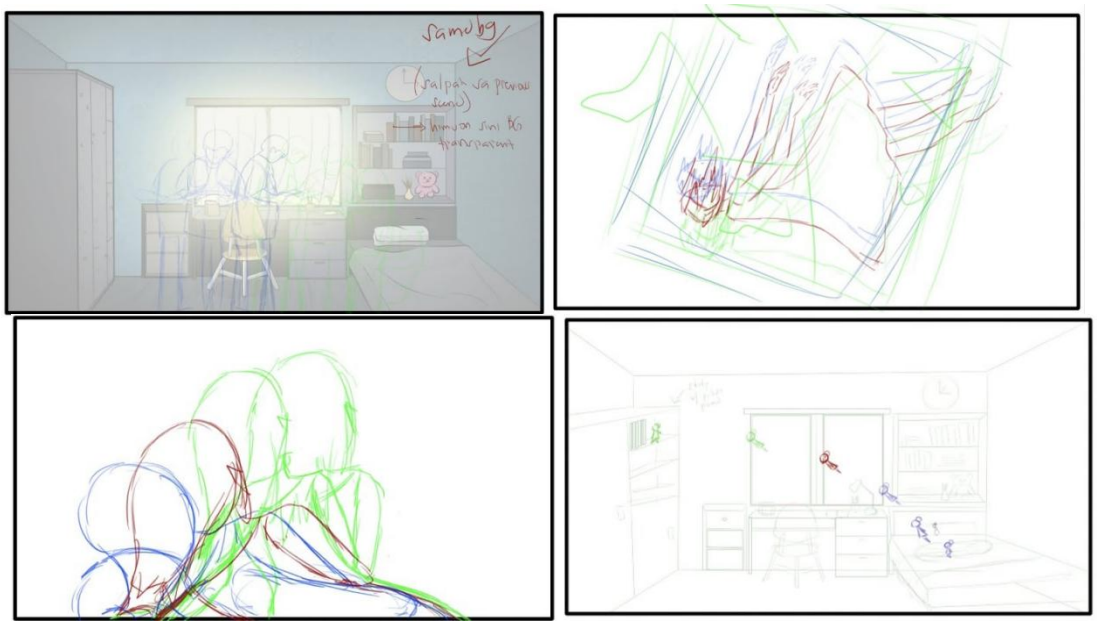
(Emphasizing how the backgrounds complement the characters and contribute to the overall visual storytelling)

Illustration of Rough Drawings for In-between

The rough drawings for the in-between frames had illustrated the essential process of refining motion and timing in animation. These sketches had served as the foundation for creating smooth transitions between key poses, ensuring that character movements had appeared natural and fluid. Through layered outlines and motion guides, the drawings had captured the dynamic flow of action and emotion, helping animators visualize how each frame had connected to the next. This stage of production had highlighted the importance of precision and consistency, as in-between drawings had played a crucial role in maintaining continuity and rhythm throughout the sequence. Ultimately, these rough drafts had reflected the careful craftsmanship and attention to detail that had brought the animation to life.



(Examples of scenes with an In-between)

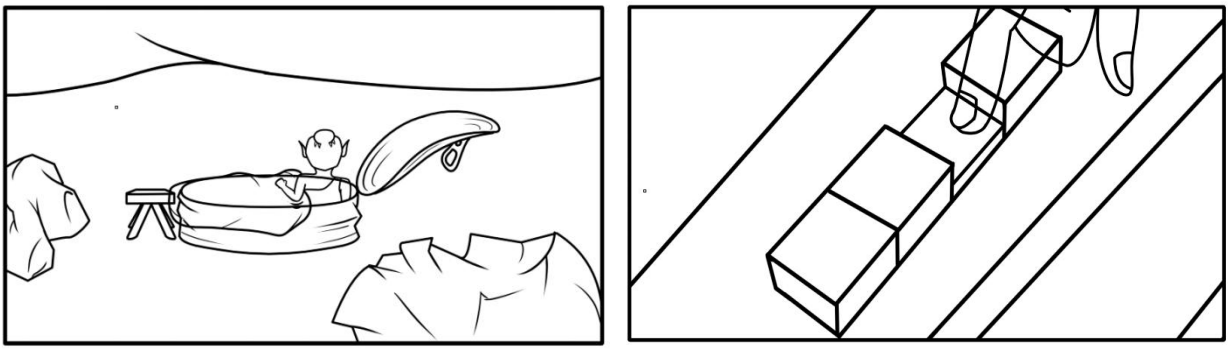
Illustration of the storyboard

The storyboard panels had illustrated the key narrative beats and emotional moments that had shaped the animation's storytelling. Each frame had captured the flow of action and character interaction, guiding the pacing and visual rhythm of the sequence. Through expressive poses and dynamic compositions, the storyboard had conveyed both the intensity of conflict and the tenderness of resolution, allowing the team to visualize how each scene would unfold. These rough sketches had served as the visual blueprint of the film, ensuring coherence between narrative intent, camera direction, and emotional tone. Ultimately, the storyboard had functioned as a crucial foundation that had bridged the written script and the final animation, providing clarity and direction for the entire production process.

(Examples of the storyboard in each scenes)

Clean-up Drawings of the Scenes:

The clean-up drawings of the scenes had demonstrated the refined craftsmanship and attention to detail achieved in the animation process. These polished line works had shown consistency in character proportions, perspective, and background design, ensuring a cohesive visual style throughout the film. The clear outlines and precise rendering had eliminated the roughness of earlier sketches, allowing the focus to shift toward clarity, composition, and visual storytelling. These drawings had highlighted the transition from conceptual planning to final production quality. Every element from the character poses to the arrangement of everyday objects had reflected intentional design choices that had enhanced realism and narrative focus. The clean-up stage had not only perfected the technical execution of each frame but had also strengthened the emotional tone and atmosphere, bringing the animation closer to its final presentation.



(Examples of Clean Up Drawings in each Scenes)

POST-PRODUCTION PHASE

Color Grading, Editing and Background Music

This capstone project had demonstrated a refined integration of visual and auditory elements that had significantly enhanced the overall narrative presentation. Through compositing and color grading, the scenes had achieved

greater depth, atmosphere, and emotional resonance. Adjustments in lighting and tone had effectively distinguished mood transitions, while the enhanced contrast and shadowing had contributed to a more cinematic and cohesive visual composition. These refinements had ensured that characters and environments had interacted seamlessly, elevating the animation's aesthetic quality and professional finish

(Differences between scenes vs. Color grading scenes)

The incorporation of music and sound effects had strengthened the storytelling by enriching the emotional and sensory experience of the audience. The background score had established mood and pacing, while synchronized sound cues such as movement, environmental ambiance, and subtle audio details had added realism and immersion. These post-production processes had unified the film's visual and auditory dimensions, resulting in a polished and engaging final output that had effectively conveyed the intended emotional and thematic impact of the animation.

Addressing Production Challenges Through Creative Problem-Solving in Animation Development

In the course of producing 'Iris', the team had faced problems that had challenged their collaboration. One had been time, there had been delays and missing scenes which had led to confusion about their pace throughout the process. They had been able to overcome this by organizing folders and dividing the film into four parts: the Exposition, Middle, Climax, and Ending.

Another challenge had been the size of Iris. Considering that she had been a tiny fairy, the animators had been challenged to keep her size consistent throughout the production. Composition had also posed difficulties. The team had taken several steps back to reconsider the tone of each scene. Since the film had been somber, they had decided to use a muted yellow to represent the absence of happiness.

Lastly, the greatest challenge of the entire production had been channeling real emotions through the characters of the film. From crying, to anger, to confusion, the members of this capstone project had revised extensively to capture a convincing replica of human emotions in this animated work.

CHAPTER V

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

This capstone project had been a culmination of the students' technical skills, creative vision, and emotional storytelling. From its early stages of scriptwriting and character design to the final processes of animation and post-editing, the project demonstrated how animation could serve not only as entertainment but also as a medium for meaningful reflection. By weaving together themes of grief, acceptance, and redemption, 'Iris' had provided audiences with a heartfelt narrative that resonated deeply and showcased the students' ability to merge artistic expression with psychological depth. The surveys, premiere observations, and audience feedback had further validated the project's success, confirming that the film achieved its intended purpose of raising awareness and sparking dialogue on mental health and family support.

Ethical Considerations

Throughout the development and evaluation of the capstone project, ethical standards were carefully observed to ensure the integrity of the research and the well-being of participants. Respondents in the survey were treated with respect, and their participation was voluntary. Informed consent was obtained, and confidentiality of their responses was maintained to protect their privacy. The project also avoided any form of exploitation or misrepresentation, ensuring that the themes of grief, acceptance, and mental health awareness were portrayed sensitively and responsibly. By adhering to these ethical practices, the study upheld academic honesty, respected

human dignity, and reinforced the value of animation as a medium for meaningful and socially responsible storytelling.

SUMMARY

'Iris' had been an artistic and deeply emotional capstone project that provided animation students with valuable insight into the power of visual storytelling in expressing human emotions. The project's development covered all key stages of the animation pipeline, including scriptwriting, storyboarding, character design, reenactment, animation production, and post-editing. By focusing on profound themes of grief, redemption, and acceptance, this was not only tested the students' technical and creative abilities to produce a visually engaging and emotionally resonant film but also reflected their dedication to using animation as a meaningful medium for portraying realistic human emotions and psychological depth. The film effectively applied the 12 Principles of Animation through deliberate staging, timing, and composition, which enhanced both storytelling and visual appeal. Each scene's framing, movement, and rhythm embodied emotional contrast—portraying grief, hope, and reconciliation between a father and his departed son strengthening the emotional impact and guiding audiences through its heartfelt narrative.

The results of the project confirmed that 'Iris' successfully conveyed its intended themes of grief, acceptance, and mental health awareness. Surveys revealed that viewers expressed strong emotional responses, finding the story relatable and impactful, while observations from the University of Iloilo – PHINMA premiere showed high engagement and reflection on the film's emotional depth. Data analysis of 22 respondents demonstrated that the narrative and artistic

style resonated well with audiences, highlighting the importance of family acceptance and emotional healing. Positive feedback on the animation's visual style, sound, and storytelling further validated its artistic merit and social relevance. By its conclusion, the film left audiences with a poignant moral about love, forgiveness, and emotional healing, proving that animation could transcend entertainment to become a powerful medium for empathy, reflection, and a deeper understanding of the human experience.

PHINMA UNIVERSITY OF ILOILO

COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY EDUCATION

CURRICULUM VITAE

AMINA PRINCES A. FUNA

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY STUDENT

CONTACT INFORMATION

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PORTFOLIO

https://tinyurl.com/bdevy9mb

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Graphic Designing (Intermediate)
- 2D & 3D Illustration (Intermediate)
- Animation (Intermediate)
- Video and Photo Editor (Intermediate)
- UI/UX (Average)
- Project Management (Average)
- Database Management (Basic)
- Technical Troubleshooting (Basic)

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES & TOOLS

- HTML (Average)
- Python (Basic)
- PHP (Basic)
- JavaScript (Basic)
- MySQL (Average)
- CSS (Average)
- Figma (Average)
- Krita | Clip Studio Paint | ibis Paint X | Medibang (Advance)
- Blender (Average)
- Capcut | Adobe Premiere Pro (Intermediate)
- PicsArt | Canva (Advance)
- Microsoft Office Suite | Google Office Suite (Advance)

PROFILE SUMMARY

I am a 4th-year Bachelor of Science in Information Technology student specializing in Digital Arts, with additional skills in Database Management, Project Management, and Web Development. While studying, I work as a customer service representative during the ramping season, which helps me strengthen my communication and multitasking skills professionally. With key professional skills including time management, communication, flexibility, critical thinking, and problem-solving, I thrive at merging creativity with technology to provide effective and engaging digital solutions.

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

PHINMA-UNIVERSITY OF ILOILO | RIZAL ST. ILOILO CITY, ILOILO | 2021 - present
- major in Digital Arts

- Certificate of Attendance, StackLeague x WorkBank Career Session: Job Search Strategies | StackLeague
- Participation Award, 55th National Students Art Competition | NSAC
- Certificate of Participation, Code Your Future: 40 Mins Coding Workshop for
- Non-Coders for Region 6 | STACKTREK
- Certificate of Attendance, Tech Student Leaders Summit 2021 | DEVCON Iloilo
- Certificate of Accomplishment, Massive Open Distance Learning(MODeL) on
- Principles of Graphic Design | University of the Philippines Open University

TESDA NCII CERTIFICATIONS OF COMPLETION

- Tesda Introduction to CSS
- Tesda Installing and Configuring Computer Systems
- Tesda Setting up Computer Networks
- Tesda Setting up Computer Server
- Tesda Maintaining Computer Systems and Network

HIGH SCHOOL

PHINMA-UNIVERSITY OF ILOILO | RIZAL ST. ILOILO CITY, ILOILO | 2012 - 2018

- Golden Pen Awardee: Respect 2014-2015 | University of Iloilo
- Certificate of Participation, 2015-2016 Dinagyang Festival Poster Making Contest | Dinagyang Festival
- 3rd Runner-Up Editorial Cartooning and Feature Writing, 2015 - 2016 Golden Pen Regional Contest | DepEd
- 3rd Runner-Up Editorial Cartooning, 2014 Golden Pen Regional Contest | DepEd

ELEMENTARY

ILOILO CENTRAL ELEMENTARY SCHOOL | GEN. LUNA ST. ILOILO CITY, ILOILO | 2006 - 2012

WORK EXPERIENCE

CUSTOMER SERVICE REPRESENTATIVE(PROJECT-BASED)

ALTIUS INSPIRO INC. (formerly INSPIRO RELIA INC.)| 2022-2025

- Worked on-site in graveyard shift during Mother's Day and Christmas Seasons only in the same Flower US-based Account.
- First position worked as an inbound customer service receiving calls direct from the customers
- In a recent position, worked as an outbound customer service by calling out florists to handily arrange the orders and fulfilling to solve the recent complaints that did not resolve during customer calls.

CUSTOMER SERVICE REPRESENTATIVE(PROJECT-BASED)

iXL SOLUTIONS INC. | MAY 2, 2021 - MAY 22, 2021

- Worked on-site during the Mother's Day Season in a Flower US-based Account
- Receiving calls for inquiry, complaints and selling floral arrangements

CURRICULUM VITAE

Clave Anthony lasconia

Sacred heart
Sara,Iloilo
09957422933
cldo.lasconia.ui@phinmaed.com

OBJECTIVES

Seeking an IT Support position to apply my technical skills and learn more about troubleshooting, system maintenance, and user support. I aim to grow within the IT field and contribute to the smooth operation of the organization's technology systems.

EXPERIENCE

Student facilitator - Phinma University of iloilo 2024-2025

Student assistant - Phinma University of iloilo Information Technology service department

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology Major in Digital Arts
phinma University of iloilo
2025-2026

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Nationality: Filipino
Status: Single
Age: 21
Gender: Male
Religion: Aglipay

PROJECTS

Suketoshop — E-commerce website

Iris — *Short animated film*

SKILLS

- Digital Arts
- Typing and data entry skills
- Basic file management and organization
- Adaptability
- Can work under pressure
- Written communication
- Verbal communication
- Basic computer troubleshooting

SEMINAR/WORKSHOP/VOLUNTEER WORK:

Computer maintenance

Photocopy and printing

REFERENCES:

Zesty Kein Mondia
PHINMA UI CITE Faculty
zgmondia.ui@phinmaed.com

John Joms Andrade
PHINMA UI CITE Faculty

LANGUAGES

English, Tagalog, Hiligaynon

PHINMA UNIVERSITY OF ILOILO

COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY EDUCATION

CURRICULUM VITAE

DREX JOEL G. PONSARAN

INFORMATION TECHNOLLOGY INTERN

CONTACT INFORMATION

+63 948 637 8150

ponsarandrexjoel04@gmail.com

PORTFOLIO

https://github.com/Khasev

https://ponsaran-portfolio.netlify.app/

SKILLS AND SOFTWARE

- Animation
  - Krita
- Digital Illustration
  - Krita, ibisPaint X, Canva
- Front-End Web Development & Programming
  - Visual Studio Code

LANGUAGES AND FRAMEWORK

- HTML, CSS, Bootstrap
- PHP, SQL
- Python (Basic)
- Java (Basic)

CORE WORK SKILLS

- Teamwork and Collaboration
- Trainability
- Attention to Detail
- Openness to Feedback and Learning

PROFILE SUMMARY

I'm Drex, a 4th-year IT student majoring in Digital Arts and Animation with a strong foundation in creative design, web development, and multimedia production. I design websites and create visual contents — from logos and posters to animations that bring ideas to life — My expertise lies in visual design and animation, supported by my front-end web development skills. Skilled in both technical and artistic aspects of IT, I am eager to apply my academic knowledge in real-world settings and contribute effectively during my On-the-Job Training (OJT). Passionate about combining technology and creativity, I aim to deliver innovative and impactful solutions.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY
PHINMA University of Iloilo | 2022 - Present

- Currently completing my degree with a focus on digital arts, animation, and front-end web development. Skilled in creating visual content, animations, and interactive designs using HTML, CSS, and Bootstrap.

SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL - HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCE
St. Robert's International Academy | 2020 - 2022

- Graduated Senior High at St. Robert's International Academy, completing the Humanities and Social Sciences (HUMSS) strand with a focus on communication, critical thinking, and creative writing.

JUNIOR HIGH SCHOOL
Mandurriao National High School | 2016 - 2020

- Graduated Junior High at Mandurriao National High School, completing TLE-ICT with basic IT and computer application skills.

ELEMENTARY SCHOOL
Hibao-an Elementary School | 2010 - 2016

- Graduated Primary Education at Hibao-an Elementary School, building fundamental academic and learning skills.

BEST PROJECTS

Iris – 2D Animated Short Film
Capstone Project | Copmpleted October 2025

- Developed as a group project exploring grief, bereavement, and hope through symbolic storytelling and visual narrative techniques.
- Contributed to pre-production by working on storyboards, reenactment concepts, and character sheets.
- Served as the clean-up artist, finalizing line work for production quality before transitioning to colorist, applying base colors for compositing.
- Collaborated with the team to ensure consistent visual style, symbolism, and emotional tone, highlighting the theme of acceptance and healing.

PredictiCare – Online Appointment System
Capstone Project | Completed April 2024

- Served as the front-end developer in a team project, building a responsive and user-friendly interface for an online medical appointment system designed to minimize on-site consultations.
- Designed interactive forms allowing users to input symptoms, age, and gender, enabling the system to analyze and suggest possible illnesses with first-aid medication.
- Ensured consistent UI/UX design while working with the team on back-end integration, database connectivity, testing, and deployment.

SCHOOL ACTIVITIES

CITEMAS - Student Organization
Member (April 2024)
Appointed 3rd Year Representative (2024–2025)

- Contributed as a designer in departmental events like CITE Week, collaborating on stage designs, props, and event execution while enhancing collaboration, creativity, teamwork, and leadership skills through teamwork across projects.

F1Stackmind - Student Organization
Member (November 2023)

- Participated in organizational activities and projects that promoted learning and knowledge-sharing in IT gaining exposure to collaborative work and professional development opportunities within the org.

PHINMA UNIVERSITY OF ILOILO

COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY EDUCATION

CURRICULUM VITAE

RHAIZA NICOLE B. BARZO

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY STUDENT

CONTACT INFORMATION

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PORTFOLIO

- barzoportfolio.netlify.app

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Digital Arts - Intermediate
- Graphic Design - Basic
- Front-End Development - Basic

CORE WORK SKILLS

- Problem Solving
- Decisiveness
- Work Ethics Teamwork
- Collaboration
- Flexibility
- Creative Thinking

PROFILE SUMMARY

An IT student majoring in Animation with a background in graphic design and a growing interest in web development. Passionate about bringing ideas to life through creative visuals, and enjoy crafting engaging content and digital designs. Demonstrates creativity, attention to detail, and a passion for combining art and technology to produce effective visual solutions.

EDUCATION

College - 2022 - 2026
- PHINMA - University of Iloilo
  Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, Major in Animation

Highschool - 2016 - 2022
- San Juan Academy Inc., ABM Strand in SHS

Elementary - 2010-2016
- Hugo T. Apelo Memorial Elementary School

WORK EXPERIENCE

Freelancer, Online Clients
2018 - 2022
Worked with commissions and graphic design projects for both local and international clients.

- Book Cover Design
- Book Cover Illustration
- Digital Art Commissions

STUDENT FACILITATOR, Instructor Assistant,
PHINMA Education | Jun 2024 - Mar 2026
Worked to assist instructors as a requirement as an HK Scholar. Senior High School and 1st Year College students.

- Facilitates student behaviors during lectures.
- Records their attendance and minor points.
- Aids the instructor during class activities.

PROJECT

Animation Short Film Capstone: "Iris"
Krita | Capcut | Clip Studio Paint
December 2024 - October 2025
Worked with a team of 4 to animate and storytell a film about grief, mental health, acceptance, and closure. Served as the Compositing Artist for the finalization of the project.

- Blended 2D and 3D elements, visual effects, and lighting to bring each scene together into a seamless final look.
- Worked hand-in-hand with the director and artists to match the project's visual tone and storytelling goals.
- Enhanced scenes through thoughtful color correction and effects to create the right mood and atmosphere.
- Made sure every shot looked polished and consistent, aligning with the creative vision and production timeline.

ACTIVITIES

CITEMAS - MEMBER & STUDENT LEADER Student Organization,
PHINMA Education | Jun 2024 - Mar 2025
An interest-based organization that have members from different departments across the PHINMA - University of Iloilo. Consisting of traditional artists, digital artists, graphic designers, video/photo editors, and many more members that uses different form of arts.

- An active member of the organization since October 2023 and served as president from June 2024 to March 2025.
- Organized school-based seminars and partnering with department council for events.
- Collaborated with other orgs for seminars and workshops.

References:

1. Williams, R. (2009). The Animator's Survival Kit: Expanded edition. Faber & Faber.

2. Keyes, K. M., Pratt, C., Galea, S., McLaughlin, K. A., Koenen, K. C., & Shear, M. K. (2014). The burden of loss: unexpected death of a loved one and psychiatric disorders across the life course in a national study. The American journal of psychiatry, 171(8), 864–871. https://doi.org/10.1176/appi.ajp.2014.1308113

3. Katz-Wise, S. L., Rosario, M., & Tsappis, M. (2016). Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, and Transgender Youth and Family Acceptance. Pediatric clinics of North America, 63(6), 1011–1025. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pcl.2016.07.005

4. Alibudbud, R. (2023). Suicide among the youth and school-based suicide prevention: Exemplar and reflections from the Philippines. Asian Journal of Psychiatry. Volume 83. ISSN 1876-2018. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ajp.2023.103538

5. Kübler-Ross, E. (1969). *On Death and Dying*. Macmillan Publishing Company.

6. Worden, J. W. (2018). *Grief Counseling and Grief Therapy: A Handbook for the Mental Health Practitioner* (5th ed.). Springer Publishing Company.